

Global Ratio Monotonicity for a Killed von Mises Bridge

[COMPLETE-THEOREM MANUSCRIPT — SEAL IN PROGRESS; DO NOT
SUBMIT.]

Pending relay lemmas are marked [SLOT].]

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Abstract

For $\beta > 0$ let $I_m = I_m(\beta)$ denote modified Bessel functions of the first kind, and set $a_m = I_m^2[(m-1)I_{m-1}^2 + (m+1)I_{m+1}^2]$, $b_m = mI_m^4$, $F_A(t) = \sum_{m \geq 1} a_m \sin(mt)$, $F_B(t) = \sum_{m \geq 1} b_m \sin(mt)$, and $E = F_A/(2F_B)$. The global ratio-monotonicity problem for the surface expansion of a two-dimensional $SU(2)$ lattice gauge observable is: (i) $F_B > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$, and (ii) $E' < 0$ on $(0, \pi)$, for every $\beta > 0$. We prove (i) twice, and prove (ii) for $0 < \beta \leq 3$ via an exact pair-identity skeleton plus an archived interval certificate executed by two independent interval-arithmetic implementations. The structural core is exact: E is, as an algebraic identity, the mean of $\cos \psi$ under the midpoint law of a four-step killed von Mises bridge; the generating kernels reduce, via the Neumann addition theorem, to two-dimensional integrals of a *single* Bessel function whose saddle deficit is an exact sum of two squares; and exact saddle cancellations yield the coefficients of the (verified) closed second-order law $E = \cos(t/2)(1 - c(t)/\beta) + O(\beta^{-2})$, $c(t) = (4 \cos^2(t/4) - 1)/(2 \cos(t/4) \cos(t/2))$. Three certified negative results (interval arithmetic, two implementations, nested enclosures) kill every monotone full-path coupling, with an exact mechanism at threshold $\beta |\cos t| = 3/2$. For the remaining range we give a two-scale closure map with a verified candidate threshold $\beta_0 = 15$ and, at the π -endpoint, exact identities for the cubic coefficient c_3 (telescoped alternating form, integral form, parity) together with its verified prefactor law. Every claim is labelled exact / certified / verified; the machine-checked lemmas are Lean 4/Mathlib, machine-checked modulo classical Bessel inputs carried as named hypotheses.

1 Introduction

This paper consolidates the resolution status of a two-part positivity problem that arises as the last analytic gap in a surface (character) expansion for two-dimensional $SU(2)$ lattice gauge theory [5, 6, 7]. The problem is stated entirely in terms of modified Bessel functions and trigonometric series, and we treat it as such; no claim of physical consequence beyond the stated expansion is made, and importance is not inherited by thematic proximity.

Throughout, $\beta > 0$, $I_m = I_m(\beta)$, and

$$a_m = I_m^2[(m-1)I_{m-1}^2 + (m+1)I_{m+1}^2], \quad b_m = mI_m^4, \quad m \geq 1. \quad (1)$$

Both sequences decay super-exponentially, so

$$F_A(t) = \sum_{m \geq 1} a_m \sin(mt), \quad F_B(t) = \sum_{m \geq 1} b_m \sin(mt), \quad E(t) = \frac{F_A(t)}{2F_B(t)}, \quad (2)$$

are real-analytic on $\mathbb{R}$, and the Wronskian $W = 2(F'_A F_B - F_A F'_B)$ satisfies $W = 4F_B^2(E)'$ wherever $F_B \neq 0$ [7].

Conjecture 1 (global ratio monotonicity). *For every $\beta > 0$: (i) $F_B > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$; (ii) $E' < 0$ on $(0, \pi)$.*

Part (i) is proved below (twice). Part (ii) is proved for $0 < \beta \leq 3$ (Theorem 34; exact skeleton plus the archived certificate `certify_thmB.py` and its Arb twin), is supported by an exact structural reduction and a verified truth map for $\beta \geq 15$, and is otherwise open; Section 9 states the precise two-scale closure map. The conjecture was born inside this programme (it is the global form of an ε -window positivity required by the surface expansion); no external pedigree is claimed.

Convention 2 (tricotomy). Every assertion below carries one of three labels. *Exact*: a proved identity or inequality. *Certified*: a numerical statement rigorously enclosed by interval arithmetic with outward rounding, together with complete analytic bounds for domains and truncations. Precision-stability re-runs and independent implementations are *software audits*, recorded separately with their declared coverage: the certified negatives `certify_time3_negative` and `certify_bridge_matrix` carry a *full twin audit* (nested re-computation plus a complete independent Arb implementation, both transcripts archived); for `certify_thmB` both implementations exist and the Arb transcript is archived — its row is *amber* only because the `mpmath.iv` canonical transcript is still in progress; the $[6, 15]$ coverage will carry a *planned pre-registered sampled independent audit* (Remark 28). *Verified*: high-precision numerics with stated grids and precision policies, not a proof. No verified statement is used as a hypothesis of an exact one.

2 The theorem and the relay

Theorem 3 (the Surface Theorem; [SLOT: seal completion]). *For every $\beta > 0$: (i) $F_B > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$, and (ii) $E' < 0$ on $(0, \pi)$.*

Part (i) is Theorem 31. Part (ii) is proved by the following relay. Rows marked [SLOT] are pending; rows marked *amber* have one archived witness with the second in progress; all other rows are complete with the stated witnesses.

range	method	artifact	transcript	state
$(0, \frac{1}{20}]$	small- β lemma	Lem. 35	—	complete
$[\frac{1}{20}, 3]$, all t	pair skeleton	<code>certify_thmB</code>	Arb	<i>amber</i>
$[3, 6]$, $t \in [0.6, \pi - \frac{1.5}{\beta}]$	series intervals	<code>certify_bulk</code>	Arb	<i>amber</i>
$[6, 15]$, $t \in [0.6, \pi - \frac{1.5}{\beta}]$	exp-factored integrator	<code>exp_integrator</code>	[SLOT]	local box: Prop. 27
$[15, \infty)$, bulk	analytic relay	[SLOT]	—	pending; on (H_{tail})
$t \in (0, 0.6]$, $\beta \geq 3$	sinc + minor criterion	[SLOT: sinc-cert]	—	design ratified
$t \in [\pi - \frac{C_{\text{win}}}{\beta}, \pi)$	c_3 + radius	[SLOT: 4 const.]	—	A verified

Splice boundaries are explicit and overlapping: $\beta = 3, 6, 15$; $t = 0.6$ and $t = \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta$, with $C_{\text{win}} = 1.5$ a candidate pending $C_{\text{mirror}} \leq 1.5 \leq C_{\text{quad}}$ (the moving-boundary constant is always written C_{win} ; the bare letter C means $\cos(t/2)$). The remainder of this manuscript is the completed material, verbatim from the consolidation paper.

Remark 4 (supersession of the e_4 route). An earlier plan closed the block $t \in (0, 0.6]$, $\beta \geq 3$ by an e_4 -coefficient lemma with a fixed radius; it is superseded, not silently deleted. A feasibility check showed the sinc criterion below dominating with ratios from 15 up to 10^{80} across $\beta \in [3, 15]$ for $t \leq 0.3$ (*verified*, design-grade), while the apparent infeasibility of $(0, 0.6]$ belonged to the cancellation of the series tool, which the exp-factored integrator does not suffer. The ratified route has three components: the exact sinc positivity (Lemma 5), cheap one-dimensional-in- β minor-criterion certificates on $(0, t_*(\beta)]$, and the extension of the integrator strip from $t = 0.6$ down to $t_*(\beta) \approx 0.45$ with splice overlap. The slot's pending content is the full minor criterion with its uniform overlap; the e_4 lemma is retired.

Lemma 5 (exact; sinc positivity). *Let $1 \leq m < n$ and $T_{mn}(t) = (m - n) \sin((m + n)t) + (m + n) \sin((n - m)t)$ as in Section 4. Then $T_{mn}(t) > 0$ for $0 < t \leq \pi/(m + n)$.*

Proof. Write $s = m + n$, $p = n - m \geq 1$, so $T_{mn}(t) = s \sin(pt) - p \sin(st)$. Since $\sin(x)/x$ is strictly decreasing on $(0, \pi]$ and $0 < pt < st \leq \pi$, we get $\sin(pt)/(pt) > \sin(st)/(st)$, i.e. $st \sin(pt) > pt \sin(st)$; dividing by $t > 0$ gives $s \sin(pt) > p \sin(st)$. $\square$

Lemma 6 (relay criterion for $\beta \in [6, 15]$). *Let $\langle f \rangle = \iint_{[-\pi, \pi]^2} K f \, ds \, d\alpha$ with $K = I_1(2\beta R)/R > 0$, and let $\bar{E}$ be any rational constant. Then $E' < 0$ at (t, β) if and only if $\langle D \rangle > 0$ and*

$$W_c := \langle N_t \rangle \langle D \rangle + \langle (N - \bar{E} D) \partial_t \log K \rangle \langle D \rangle - (\langle N \rangle - \bar{E} \langle D \rangle) \langle D \partial_t \log K \rangle < 0$$

(the $\bar{E}$ -terms cancel identically). The certificate encloses the five integrals by exp-factored interval cells: $z = 2\beta R$ is linearized at the exact rational cell center with interval-gradient remainder; the linear exponential integrates exactly; and the two scaled Bessel factors are $A(z) = e^{-z} I_1(z)/z$ — strictly decreasing, since $(\log A)' = I_0/I_1 - 1 - 2/z < 0$ follows from the classical lower bound at $\nu = 0$ (Amos [1]; [2], Thm. 1) and $\sqrt{1 + z^2} \leq z + 1$ — enclosed by pure endpoint evaluation, and $B(z) = e^{-z} H_B(z)$, where

$$H_B(z) := \frac{I_0(z) - 2I_1(z)/z}{z^2} = \frac{I_2(z)}{z^2}, \quad H_B(0) = \frac{1}{8}$$

(the second equality is the recurrence [4, 10.29.1] at $\nu = 1$; positive-coefficient entire series; the subscript distinguishes it from the entry-law kernel $H(\psi)$), enclosed unconditionally by $[e^{-z_{\text{hi}}} H_B(z_{\text{lo}}), e^{-z_{\text{lo}}} H_B(z_{\text{hi}})]$; the identity $K \partial_t \log K = 32\beta^3 c' (1 - P - Q) H_B(z)$, $c = \cos(t/4)$, removes $I_1(z)/z$ from the covariance integrands exactly. The (t, β) -box layer is Proposition 27; the global $[6, 15]$ coverage remains the pending content of the relay row.

Lemma 7 (exact; the S -free relative criterion). *Let $S = \sin(t/2)$, $E = \langle N \rangle / \langle D \rangle$, and suppose $\langle D \rangle > 0$. Then for all $t \in (0, \pi)$ and $\beta > 0$,*

$$\frac{E'(t, \beta)}{-\frac{1}{2}S} = \frac{\langle \cos 2s + \cos \alpha \cos s \rangle + 8\beta^3 \iint (N - E D)(1 - P - Q) H_B(z) \, ds \, d\alpha}{\langle D \rangle},$$

and consequently

$$E' < -\frac{1}{4}S \iff \mathcal{C} := \langle \cos 2s + \cos \alpha \cos s \rangle + 8\beta^3 \iint (N - E D)(1 - P - Q) H_B - \frac{1}{2} \langle D \rangle > 0.$$

Proof. Since $D_t = 0$, $E' = [\langle N_t \rangle + \iint (N - ED) \partial_t K] / \langle D \rangle$. The first term factors S exactly: $N_t = -\frac{S}{2}(\cos 2s + \cos \alpha \cos s)$. So does the second: $\partial_t K = K \partial_t \log K = 32\beta^3 c c' (1 - P - Q) H_B(z)$ with $c = \cos(t/4)$, and $c c' = \cos(t/4) \cdot (-\frac{1}{4} \sin(t/4)) = -\frac{S}{8}$ by the double angle, so $\partial_t K = -4\beta^3 S (1 - P - Q) H_B$. Dividing by $-\frac{1}{2}S$ cancels S identically and yields the display. For the equivalence: the denominator $-\frac{1}{2}S$ is negative on $(0, \pi)$, so $E' < -\frac{1}{4}S$ is the *lower* bound $E' / (-\frac{1}{2}S) > \frac{1}{2}$, i.e. $\mathcal{C} > 0$. $\square$

Corollary 8 (exact; the bilinear quotient-free form). *With $\Phi := \cos 2s + \cos \alpha \cos s$ (the letter A stays reserved for the scaled Bessel factor $e^{-z} I_1(z)/z$), $J_N := \iint N(1 - P - Q) H_B ds d\alpha$, $J_D := \iint D(1 - P - Q) H_B ds d\alpha$, and $\langle D \rangle > 0$,*

$$E' < -\frac{1}{4} \sin(t/2) \iff \hat{\mathcal{C}} := \langle D \rangle \langle \Phi \rangle + 8\beta^3 (\langle D \rangle J_N - \langle N \rangle J_D) - \frac{1}{2} \langle D \rangle^2 > 0.$$

Proof. Multiply $\mathcal{C}$ of Lemma 7 by $\langle D \rangle > 0$ and substitute $E = \langle N \rangle / \langle D \rangle$: the quotient disappears by bilinearity, and the inequality direction is preserved. $\hat{\mathcal{C}}$ is a bilinear combination of five integrals with no quotient anywhere; it is the assembly's sole target. $\square$

Remark 9 (why $\hat{\mathcal{C}}$ is the assembly's object). In $\hat{\mathcal{C}}$ the variable t enters only through $c = \cos(t/4) \in (\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}, 1)$: no kinematically forced vanishing factor and no singularity anywhere in the relay range — the common linear zero of margin and correction at $t \rightarrow 0$ has been cancelled identically. The endpoint degeneracy is thus removed structurally; uniform positivity still requires explicit uniform estimates, which are the assembly's content. The first-order calibration constant is $a(t) = [\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{8c^2}] / c \leq \frac{3\sqrt{2}}{4} \approx 1.061$ (supremum at $c = \sqrt{2}/2$), so the first-order threshold is $2 \sup a \approx 2.12$; the target of the analytic relay is $\hat{\mathcal{C}} > 0$ uniformly for $\beta \geq \beta_0$ with the remainder included. At the calibration point $(t, \beta) = (1.5, 8)$ the measured value is $\mathcal{C} / \langle D \rangle \approx 0.417$ (*verified*), against the threshold 0. The built-in unit test: the $1/\beta$ expansion of $\mathcal{C} / \langle D \rangle + \frac{1}{2}$ must reproduce $1 - a(t)/\beta$; the audited quantity is $\beta \cdot$ (deviation from first order), which must converge (an $O(\beta^{-2})$ remainder halves the β -scaled deviation when β doubles, and divides the unscaled deviation by four).

Lemma 10 (exact; far-region pointwise and kernel bounds). (a) $\min_{s,\alpha} \Phi = -\frac{9}{8}$ *exactly: with $u = |\cos s|$ the minimum of $2u^2 - u - 1$ on $[0, 1]$ is attained at $u = \frac{1}{4}$ and equals $-\frac{9}{8}$* . (b) $|D| \leq 2$ and, by Corollary 38 ($|E| < 1$), $|N - ED| \leq |N| + |D| \leq (2|C| + 1) + 2 \leq 5$ and $|1 - P - Q| \leq 1$. (c) On the deficit region $\{(s, \alpha) : 2c - R \geq \Delta_0\}$ one has $z = 2\beta R \leq z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0$ with $z_s = 4\beta c$, and since $A(z) = e^{-z} I_1(z)/z$ is strictly decreasing with $A(0^+) = \frac{1}{2}$,

$$K = 2\beta e^z A(z) \leq \beta e^{z_s} e^{-2\beta\Delta_0} \quad \text{on the region.}$$

The far-region contributions of all five integrals of Corollary 8 are then bounded by the two tail families of Lemma 11 below.

Proof. (a) $\cos \alpha \cos s \geq -|\cos s|$ with equality attainable, and $\cos 2s = 2u^2 - 1$; minimizing $g(u) = 2u^2 - u - 1$ gives $g(\frac{1}{4}) = -\frac{9}{8}$. (b) Triangle inequalities; $|N| \leq |C| |\cos 2s| + |\cos \alpha| (|C \cos s| + \sin^2 s) \leq 2|C| + 1$. (c) $R \leq 2c - \Delta_0$ gives $z \leq z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0$; write $K = I_1(z)/R = 2\beta I_1(z)/z = 2\beta e^z A(z)$ and use the monotonicity of A (Section on the two scaled functions) with $A(z) \leq A(0^+) = \frac{1}{2}$ uniformly. $\square$

Lemma 11 (exact; the two tail families). $0 < H_B(z) \leq \frac{1}{4} I_1(z)/z = \frac{1}{4} e^z A(z) \leq \frac{1}{8} e^z$ (term by term: the coefficient of $(z/2)^{2k}$ in H_B is $\frac{1}{4} \frac{1}{(k+2)k!(k+1)!} \leq \frac{1}{8k!(k+1)!}$, the coefficient in $\frac{1}{4} I_1(z)/z$

being $\frac{1}{8k!(k+1)!}$). Consequently, writing δX for the far-region part of an integral X over $\{2c - R \geq \Delta_0\}$,

$$|\delta\langle f \rangle| \leq 4\pi^2 |f|_\infty \beta e^{z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0}, \quad |\delta J_f| \leq \frac{\pi^2}{2} |f(1 - P - Q)|_\infty e^{z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0},$$

for the three K -integrals and the two H_B -integrals respectively; on the same region $z \leq z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0$ also bounds e^z in $H_B \leq \frac{1}{8}e^z$.

Proposition 12 (exact; Region III propagation). *Let $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_{\text{near}}$ denote $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}$ with every integral restricted to $\{2c - R < \Delta_0\}$. Then for every $\Delta_0 \in (0, 2c)$ and $\beta \geq 1$,*

$$|\widehat{\mathcal{C}} - \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_{\text{near}}| \leq 576\pi^4 \beta^4 e^{2z_s} e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}.$$

Proof. Global masses: $\iint K \leq 4\pi^2 \beta e^{z_s} =: M$ and $\iint H_B \leq \frac{\pi^2}{2} e^{z_s} =: M_H$ (the pointwise bounds $K \leq \beta e^{z_s}$, $H_B \leq \frac{1}{8}e^{z_s}$ hold on all of $[-\pi, \pi]^2$ since $z \leq z_s$). With the pointwise constants of Lemma 10 ($|\Phi|_\infty \leq 2$, $|D|_\infty \leq 2$, $|N|_\infty \leq 3$, $|N(1 - P - Q)|_\infty \leq 3$, $|D(1 - P - Q)|_\infty \leq 2$), Lemma 11 gives $|\delta\langle D \rangle|, |\delta\langle \Phi \rangle| \leq 2a$, $|\delta\langle N \rangle| \leq 3a$, $|\delta J_N| \leq 3b$, $|\delta J_D| \leq 2b$, where $a := M e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}$, $b := M_H e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}$ (note $4\pi^2 \beta e^{z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0} = a$ and $\frac{\pi^2}{2} e^{z_s - 2\beta\Delta_0} = b$). For any product, $|XY - X_n Y_n| \leq |\delta X| |Y|_{\max} + |X|_{\max} |\delta Y|$ with $|\langle f \rangle| \leq |f|_\infty M$, $|J_f| \leq |f(1 - P - Q)|_\infty M_H$. Summing: $\langle D \rangle \langle \Phi \rangle$ contributes $\leq 8aM$; $\langle D \rangle J_N$ and $\langle N \rangle J_D$ contribute $\leq 12MM_H e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}$ each (using $aM_H = bM = MM_H e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}$); $\frac{1}{2}\langle D \rangle^2$ contributes $\leq 4aM$. Total: $12aM + 192\beta^3 MM_H e^{-2\beta\Delta_0} = (192\pi^4 \beta^2 + 384\pi^4 \beta^4) e^{2z_s} e^{-2\beta\Delta_0} \leq 576\pi^4 \beta^4 e^{2z_s} e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}$ for $\beta \geq 1$. $\square$

Remark 13 (the choice of Δ_0 belongs to the assembly). With these deliberately crude (but fully named) constants, at $\beta = 15$ the bound forces $\Delta_0 \approx 1.2$ rather than the design value 0.3: the natural saddle-mass scale is $\langle D \rangle \asymp e^{z_s} \beta^{-3/2}$ (saddle height $\asymp e^{z_s} \beta^{-1/2}$ times a two-dimensional Gaussian area $\asymp \beta^{-1}$), so $\langle D \rangle^2 \asymp e^{2z_s} \beta^{-3}$ and the comparison quotient carries $\beta^7 e^{-2\beta\Delta_0}$, consuming ≈ 34 of exponent at $\beta = 15$. By Lemma 19 ($m_* \geq \frac{1}{2}$), $\Delta_0 = 1.2$ suffices with margin (Corollary 14). The enlargement changes no leading bound, subject to the forthcoming geometric shell estimate: the shell technique that will bound Region II is insensitive to its outer edge — the telescoping sum over deficit shells is controlled by the kernel mass beyond the *inner* radius Δ_1 (up to its geometric closing factor, part of that estimate). Since $\Delta_0 < 2c$ is free, the constant hunt stays honest.

Corollary 14 (Region III numeric tooth). *By Lemma 19 ($m_* \geq \frac{1}{2}$), for $\beta \geq 15$ and $t \in (0, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]$, with $\Delta_0 = 1.2$,*

$$\frac{|\widehat{\mathcal{C}} - \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_{\text{near}}|}{\langle D \rangle^2} \leq \frac{576\pi^4}{m_*^2} \beta^7 e^{-2.4\beta} \leq 2304\pi^4 \beta^7 e^{-2.4\beta},$$

and the right side is decreasing in β on $[15, \infty)$ ($\frac{d}{d\beta} \log(\beta^7 e^{-2.4\beta}) = \frac{7}{\beta} - 2.4 < 0$ for $\beta \geq 15$), with value $\leq 8.9 \times 10^{-3}$ at $\beta = 15$: a single evaluation certifies the whole half-line. (An earlier draft hypothesized $m_0 = 1$, consistent with every measurement but not reached by the proven floor; it is superseded by Lemma 19, not falsified — constant four times uglier, foundation harder.)

Convention 15 (cited constants travel with their normalization). All double integrals in this section are over $[-\pi, \pi]^2$ with no normalization: $\langle f \rangle := \iint K f ds d\alpha$. Every numerically measured constant quoted in this manuscript travels with its triplet (normalization, t , β); the saddle-mass lemma is stated as an explicit function $m_0(c)$, never as a loose scalar, since the saddle prefactor carries a c -dependence and measurements confirm it ($m_0 \approx 1.492$ at $(t, \beta) = (1.5, 15)$, 2.110

at (2.5, 15), 1.353 at (1.0, 40) under this convention). The one historical discrepancy is *closed exactly*: via $F_B = \frac{\beta \sin(t/2)}{16\pi^2} \langle D \rangle$, i.e. $\langle D \rangle = 16\pi^2 F_B / (\beta \sin(t/2))$, the F_B -series reproduces all three readings; an earlier report of 1.05 was the (2.5, 15) value computed with the bracket $D/2$ in place of D — a factor of exactly 2, identified, not a numerical uncertainty. Uniform floors are written $m_* := \inf_{c \in [\sqrt{2}/2, 1]} m_0(c)$.

Lemma 16 (exact; analytic lower bound for I_1). *For $z \geq 2$, $I_1(z) \geq \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}}(1 - \frac{1}{2z}) - \frac{3}{2}$; consequently $I_1(z) \geq \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}}(1 - \frac{0.6}{z})$ for $z \geq 10$.*

Proof. From $I_1(z) = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^\pi e^{z \cos \theta} \cos \theta d\theta$ and $u = \sin(\theta/2)$, $I_1(z) = \frac{2e^z}{\pi} \int_0^1 e^{-2zu^2} \frac{1-2u^2}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} du$. On $[0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}]$ drop $\frac{1}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} \geq 1$ (there $1-2u^2 \geq 0$) and complete the Gaussian: $\int_0^\infty e^{-2zu^2} (1-2u^2) du = \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{2z}} (1 - \frac{1}{2z})$, at the cost of the Gaussian residue, derived by $u^2 = \frac{1}{2} + v$ (so $2u^2 - 1 = 2v$, $du \leq dv/\sqrt{2}$): $\int_{1/\sqrt{2}}^\infty e^{-2zu^2} (2u^2 - 1) du \leq \sqrt{2} e^{-z} \int_0^\infty v e^{-2zv} dv = \frac{e^{-z}}{2\sqrt{2}z^2} \leq \frac{3}{z} e^{-z}$. On $[\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, 1]$, $|1-2u^2| \leq 1$ and $e^{-2zu^2} \leq e^{-z}$ give at most $\frac{\pi}{4} e^{-z}$. Multiplying by $\frac{2e^z}{\pi}$: the main term is $\frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}}(1 - \frac{1}{2z})$, the two tails contribute at most $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{6}{\pi z} \leq \frac{3}{2}$ for $z \geq 2$. For the corollary: at $z \geq 10$, $\frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}} \cdot \frac{0.1}{z} \geq \frac{e^{10}}{\sqrt{20\pi}} \cdot \frac{1}{100} \approx 27.8 \geq \frac{3}{2}$, and the left side increases in z . $\square$

Lemma 17 (exact; global upper companion for I_1). *For every $z > 0$, $I_1(z) \leq e^z / \sqrt{2\pi z}$.*

Proof. In the representation of Lemma 16, $I_1(z) = \frac{2e^z}{\pi} \int_0^1 e^{-2zu^2} \frac{1-2u^2}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} du$, the integrand is ≤ 0 on $[\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, 1]$; on $[0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}]$ one has $\frac{1-2u^2}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} \leq 1$: squaring is legitimate there ($1-2u^2 \geq 0$) and reduces the claim to $u^2(4u^2-3) \leq 0$, true for $u^2 \leq \frac{3}{4}$. Hence $I_1(z) \leq \frac{2e^z}{\pi} \int_0^\infty e^{-2zu^2} du = \frac{2e^z}{\pi} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{2z}} = \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}}$. (The companions of Lemma 23 sharpen this for $z \geq 20$; the point of the global form is the range $z < 20$, which the rest bound of Lemma 19 genuinely visits.) $\square$

Lemma 18 (exact; the area lemma). *For $0 \leq u < 1$,*

$$\text{Area}\{(s, \alpha) \in [-\pi, \pi]^2 : P + Q \leq u\} \leq \frac{4\pi u}{\sqrt{1-u}},$$

and the same bound holds for the mirror set $\{\tilde{P} + \tilde{Q} \leq u\}$, $\tilde{P} := 1 - P$, $\tilde{Q} := 1 - Q$. Consequently, for $c^2 \geq \frac{1}{2}$ (so $w \geq g := P + Q - 2PQ$),

$$\text{Area}\{w \leq v\} \leq \bar{A}(v) := \min\left(\frac{16\pi v}{\sqrt{1-2v}} \Big|_{v < \frac{1}{2}}, 4\pi^3 v\right),$$

with $\bar{A}$ nondecreasing (a minimum of two increasing branches; they cross at $v_c = \frac{1}{2}(1 - 16/\pi^4) = 0.41787\dots$).

Proof. On $[0, \pi]^2$ the substitution $dP = \sqrt{P(1-P)} ds$ gives

$$\text{Area}_{[0, \pi]^2}\{P + Q \leq u\} = \iint_{P+Q \leq u} \frac{dP dQ}{\sqrt{PQ(1-P)(1-Q)}} \leq \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-u}} \iint_{P+Q \leq u} \frac{dP dQ}{\sqrt{PQ}} = \frac{\pi u}{\sqrt{1-u}}$$

$((1-P)(1-Q) \geq 1-u$ on the region; the last integral is u times the exact Beta integral $\Gamma(\frac{1}{2})^2/\Gamma(2) = \pi$); the full square is four copies, and the mirror set is the image under $(s, \alpha) \mapsto (\pi - s, \pi - \alpha)$. For the deficit sublevels: g is invariant under the mirror substitution and

$g \geq \frac{1}{2}(P + Q)$ where $P + Q \leq 1$, so $\{g \leq v\} \subset \{P + Q \leq 2v\} \cup \{\tilde{P} + \tilde{Q} \leq 2v\}$ and the first branch follows; globally $P \geq (s/\pi)^2$ (concavity of $\sin$) puts each component inside a region of area $2\pi^3 v$. $\square$

Lemma 19 (chains exact, floor certified; the signed minoration: uniform saddle mass). *Define $m(\beta, c) := \beta^{3/2} e^{-4\beta c} \langle D \rangle$ and the window-uniform mass $m_* := \inf\{m(\beta, c) : \beta \geq 15, t \in (0, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]\}$. For every $\beta \geq 15$ and $t \in (0, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]$,*

$$m(\beta, c) \geq m_{\text{low}}(\beta, c) := T_1 - T_G - T_M - T_R \geq \frac{1}{2},$$

with the four explicit pieces displayed in the proof; in particular $m_ \geq \frac{1}{2}$, and every statement of this manuscript carried on the candidate floor $m_* \geq \frac{1}{2}$ is unconditional from here on. The window is not cosmetic: at $t = \pi$ one has $c = s_4$, the involution of Remark 20 becomes a symmetry of K , and $\langle D \rangle = 0$ identically.*

Remark 20 (the sign gap, exposed by the involution). A restricted-domain bound $\int_B KD \geq (\dots)$ on a rectangle B around the saddle cannot by itself minorize $\langle D \rangle = \iint KD$, because D changes sign on the torus: under the exact involution $T(s, \alpha) = (\pi - s, \pi - \alpha)$ one has $D \circ T = -D$ and $K_c \circ T = K_{s_4}$ with $s_4 = \sin(t/4)$, so the mirror ball contributes $\int_{T(B)} K_c D = -\int_B K_{s_4} D < 0$ — a negative part the restricted-domain argument omitted. The owed repair is the *signed minoration* $\langle D \rangle \geq L_{\text{main}}(c) - U_{\text{mirror}}(s_4) - U_{\text{rest}}$, where the mirror term carries the exact relative suppression $e^{-4\beta(c-s_4)} \leq e^{-4C_{\text{win}}/\pi} \approx 0.148$ at the moving boundary (via $c - s_4 = \sqrt{2} \sin \frac{\pi-t}{4} \geq \frac{\pi-t}{\pi}$ from $\sin y \geq \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{\pi} y$ on $[0, \frac{\pi}{4}]$) — order one, not negligible; note also $s_4 \in (0, \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2})$ falls *outside* the main range, so the mirror-ball upper bound needs its own (upper) chain — supplied by step (iii) of the proof of Lemma 19. The measured $m_0 \in [1.35, 2.11]$ now calibrates the lemma's floor (slack 2.2–4.2×: a floor, not an asymptote).

Proof of Lemma 19. Split the torus into the main rectangle $B = [-r, r]^2$, $r = \frac{6}{5}$, the mirror rectangle $B' = \{|s| \geq \pi - r, |\alpha| \geq \pi - r\}$, and the rest. On B the identity $KD = 2K - 2K(P + Q)$ is exact ($D = 2(1 - P - Q)$); off B we pay $|D| \leq 2$:

$$\langle D \rangle \geq 2 \int_B K - 2 \int_B K(P + Q) - 2 \int_{B'} K - 2 \int_{\text{rest}} K.$$

On B , $w \leq P + Q \leq 2 \sin^2 \frac{r}{2} = w_{\text{max}} = 0.6377$, so $z = z_s \sqrt{1 - w} \geq 0.6019 z_s \geq 25.5$.

(i) *The main mass, from below.* By the lower companion of Lemma 23; the frozen-prefactor monotonicity $(x^{-3/2}(1 - a/x - b/x^2))$ decreases on $x \in [0.6, 1]$ for $a \leq \frac{3}{160}$, $b \leq \frac{0.6}{400}$; mini-lemma (a) ($z \leq z_s$, so the bracket freezes at z_s); the root from below $\sqrt{1 - w} \geq 1 - \frac{w}{2} - \frac{w^2}{4}$ (valid to $w = 2(\sqrt{2} - 1)$); the factorization $w^2 \leq (P + Q)^2 \leq 2(P^2 + Q^2)$ with $P \leq s^2/4$, which splits the quartic penalty per variable; $e^{-x} \geq 1 - x$; $\text{erfc}(x) \leq e^{-x^2}$; and exact Gaussian moments:

$$2\beta^{3/2} e^{-z_s} \int_B K \geq T_1 := \frac{\sqrt{2\pi}}{2} c^{-5/2} \left(1 - \frac{3}{8z_s} - \frac{0.6}{z_s^2}\right) \left(1 - e^{-18\beta c/25} - \frac{3}{8\beta c}\right)^2.$$

(ii) *The $K(P + Q)$ correction, from above.* With the upper companion; the exact prefactor identity $z^{-3/2} = z_s^{-3/2} (1 - w)^{-3/4}$; $e^{z-z_s} \leq e^{-2\beta c w}$; the convexity-endpoint absorption $(1 - w)^{-3/4} e^{-\beta_1 c_1 w/10} \leq 1.089$ on $[0, w_{\text{max}}]$ ($\beta_1 c_1 = 15/\sqrt{2}$); the rate floor $w \geq 0.6811(P + Q)$ on B ($c^2 \geq \frac{1}{2}$); the concavity floor $P \geq 0.2214 s^2$ on $|s| \leq r$; and the exact Gamma moment:

$$2\beta^{3/2} e^{-z_s} \int_B K(P + Q) \leq T_G := \frac{\beta}{2\sqrt{2\pi} c^{3/2}} \cdot \frac{1.089(\pi/4)}{(0.2214 \cdot 1.9 \cdot 0.6811 \beta c)^2} \leq \frac{2.0784}{\beta c^{7/2}}.$$

(iii) *The mirror, from above.* The chart identity $1 - w = (s_4/c)^2(1 - w')$, $w' = P' + Q' - P'Q'/s_4^2$, $P' = \cos^2(s/2)$, is exact, so on B' one has $z = z_s(s_4)\sqrt{1 - w'}$, $z_s(s_4) = 4\beta s_4$, with the exact relative suppression $e^{-4\beta\delta_4}$. Three zones. For $s_4 \geq 0.58$ (where $w' \geq 0$ on B' needs only $s_4 \geq \sin(0.6)/\sqrt{2} = 0.3993$, and $z \geq 20.9$ at the worst corner) the machinery of (ii) transplants verbatim to the chart:

$$2\beta^{3/2}e^{-z_s} \int_{B'} K \leq T_M := \frac{\beta}{2\sqrt{2\pi} s_4^{3/2}} \cdot \frac{1.230\pi}{0.2214 \cdot 1.9(1 - \frac{w_{\max}}{4s_4^2})\beta s_4} e^{-4\beta\delta_4}.$$

For $s_4 \in [0.40, 0.58]$: $z \leq z_s(s_4)$ on B' and $K = 2\beta A(z)e^z \leq \beta e^{z_s(s_4)}$ give $T_M = 8r^2\beta^{5/2}e^{-4\beta\delta_4}$ with $\delta_4 \geq 0.2346$ — dead. For $s_4 < 0.40$: $R^2 \leq 4c^2\sin^4(0.6) + 4s_4^2$ on B' gives $T_M = 8r^2\beta^{5/2}e^{-4\beta\Delta_{\text{far}}}$, $\Delta_{\text{far}} \geq 0.4211$ — dead.

(iv) *The rest, from above.* Outside $B \cup B'$ the case analysis on $g = P + Q - 2PQ$ gives the floor $w \geq \sin^2(0.6) > 0.318$. The kernel majorant $K \leq 2\beta e^z/(\sqrt{2\pi}z^{3/2})$ is witnessed on all of $z > 0$ by Lemma 17 (the layers below reach $z \approx 13.4$ at the window corner, outside the companions' range). With Lemma 18 sharpened by the disk $s^2 + \alpha^2 \leq 4\sin^2(0.6)$ (it lies inside B with $P + Q \leq \sin^2(0.6) \leq v$, so its area $4\pi\sin^2(0.6) \geq 4.006$ is never rest-mass: $\bar{A}_r := \bar{A} - 4.006$), the Abel-corrected layer sum on the fixed grid $v_0 = 0.318$, $\delta v = 0.02$, $V = 0.9$, with $\varphi(v) = (1 - v)^{-3/4}e^{-2\beta cv}$ (decreasing there for $\beta c \geq 3.75$):

$$T_R := \frac{\beta}{2\sqrt{2\pi}c^{3/2}} \left[\varphi(v_0)\bar{A}_r(v_1) + \sum_{k \geq 1} \varphi(v_k)(\bar{A}_r(v_{k+1}) - \bar{A}_r(v_k)) \right] + 2(2\pi)^2\beta^{5/2}e^{-(1-\sqrt{0.1})z_s}.$$

The bottom-mass term is not optional — the first layer's mass may be all of $\bar{A}_r(v_1)$; the shard covers $\{w > 0.9\}$ via $z \leq z_s\sqrt{0.1}$ and $K \leq \beta e^z$.

(v) *The floor.* Every piece of m_{low} is monotone in β at fixed t in the favorable direction (the T_1 brackets increase; $T_G \sim \beta^{-1}$; the zone- L mirror is a β -free coefficient times $e^{-4\beta\delta_4}$; the crude zones and the shard are $\beta^{5/2}e^{-\beta\text{-const}}$ with constants far above the $5/(2\beta)$ threshold; each layer term $\beta\varphi(v_k)$ decreases for $\beta \geq 1/(2cv_0)$), so the infimum sits on $\beta_{\min}(t) = \max(15, C_{\text{win}}/(\pi - t))$, and the resulting one-dimensional floor is *certified* by interval arithmetic (python-flint arb, 120 bits; transcript `cascade1_floor_arb_transcript.txt`, committed): 800 intervals plus a stub on $t \in (0, \pi - 0.1]$ at $\beta = 15$, worst enclosure lower bound 1.03611; 60 overlapping hull boxes along the moving boundary, worst 0.811835; and the deep tail $\pi - t \leq 10^{-3}$ by hand-monotone reductions, enclosure $[2.20442, 2.21398]$ — all $> \frac{1}{2}$, ball-and-boolean. Design calibration (verified, bearing no load): $m_{\text{true}}/m_{\text{low}} = 1.10\text{--}1.95$ across seven bench cells with every chain piece dominating its true counterpart, and the bench's independent $m_{\text{true}}(1.5, 15) = 1.4918$ reproduces the 1.492 of Convention 15. The chain constants of (i)–(iv) are exact consequences of the named lemmas; the elementary links are design-checked in `cascade1_signed_minoration.py` (committed with transcript; five independent audit rounds on the fabrication, their transcripts committed). $\square$

Lemma 21 (exact; two global mini-lemmas for Step 0). (a) *If $c^2 \geq \frac{1}{2}$ (the whole relay range) then $R \leq 2c$, i.e. $z \leq z_s$, on all of $[-\pi, \pi]^2$: indeed $4c^2 - R^2 = 4c^2(P + Q) - 4PQ \geq 8c^2\sqrt{PQ} - 4PQ = 4\sqrt{PQ}(2c^2 - \sqrt{PQ}) \geq 0$ since $\sqrt{PQ} \leq 1 \leq 2c^2$.* (b) *The fluctuation $F := N - CD$ satisfies the global pointwise bound $|F| \leq 12P$: from $\cos 2s - \cos s = -2\sin(3s/2)\sin(s/2)$ and $1 - \cos s = 2\sin^2(s/2)$,*

$$F = -2C \sin(3s/2) \sin(s/2) - \cos \alpha [2C \sin^2(s/2) + \sin^2 s],$$

and $|\sin(3s/2)| \leq 3|\sin(s/2)|$, $\sin^2 s = 4P(1-P) \leq 4P$, $|C| \leq 1$ give $|F| \leq 6P + (2P + 4P) = 12P$.

Remark 22 (certified; Step 0 of the assembly: the E -window). Lemma 21 makes the first assembly step a single moment estimate: $|E - C| = |\langle F \rangle|/\langle D \rangle \leq 12\langle P \rangle_K/\langle D \rangle$, with no case split (the F -bound is global, and (a) orients every kernel bound in one direction on the whole torus). The moment bound is *certified*, in the additive-mirror form the truth demands (the mirror mass sits at $P \approx 1$ and contributes $O(e^{-4\beta\delta_4}) = O(1)$ on the moving boundary, so no purely multiplicative window constant can exist near $t = \pi$): for $\beta \geq 15$, $t \in (0, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]$,

$$\frac{\langle P \rangle_K}{\langle D \rangle} \leq \frac{1 + \varepsilon_b}{4\beta c} + 3e^{-2\beta\delta_4}, \quad \varepsilon_b = \begin{cases} 4.0, & t \leq 2.89, \\ 8.8, & t > 2.89, \end{cases}$$

whence $|E - C| \leq \frac{3}{\beta c}(1 + \varepsilon_b) + 36e^{-2\beta\delta_4}$. The constants ride Lemma 19's chains ($\langle P \rangle \leq \frac{1}{2} \int_B K(P + Q)$ plus the mirror and rest masses, $\langle D \rangle \geq m_{\text{low}}$) and were certified by the same interval sweep (transcript `cascade2_step0_eps_transcript.txt`, committed; the certificate's bulk zone extends to the binary64 value 2.899999999999999112, and 2.89 is stated so the claim stays strictly inside it). Against the exact first-order $\kappa(c) = (4c^2 - 1)/(2c) \leq \frac{3}{2}$ the bulk constant carries a factor ≈ 10 of slack — fat, said plainly; its clients are bounded, not flattered: the $\times 2$ -class μ_F input for the mirror clause rides the extracted leading coefficients, not this window. The eight-cell calibration table ($\beta|E - C| \nearrow \kappa(c)$ from below) is the step's unit test.

Lemma 23 (exact; two-term two-sided Bessel companions). *For $z \geq 20$,*

$$I_1(z) = \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}} \left(1 - \frac{3}{8z} + \varepsilon_1(z)\right), \quad I_0(z) = \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}} \left(1 + \frac{1}{8z} + \varepsilon_0(z)\right),$$

with $|\varepsilon_1(z)| \leq 0.6/z^2$ and $|\varepsilon_0(z)| \leq 0.4/z^2$; and, one order deeper by the same chain,

$$I_1(z) = \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}} \left(1 - \frac{3}{8z} - \frac{15}{128z^2} + \varepsilon_1^{(3)}(z)\right), \quad I_0(z) = \frac{e^z}{\sqrt{2\pi z}} \left(1 + \frac{1}{8z} + \frac{9}{128z^2} + \varepsilon_0^{(3)}(z)\right),$$

with $|\varepsilon_1^{(3)}(z)| \leq 1.02/z^3$ and $|\varepsilon_0^{(3)}(z)| \leq 0.84/z^3$.

Proof. Both start from the representations in the proof of Lemma 16: with $u = \sin(\theta/2)$,

$$I_1(z) = \frac{2e^z}{\pi} \int_0^1 e^{-2zu^2} \frac{1 - 2u^2}{\sqrt{1 - u^2}} du, \quad I_0(z) = \frac{2e^z}{\pi} \int_0^1 \frac{e^{-2zu^2}}{\sqrt{1 - u^2}} du.$$

On $[0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}]$ expand the algebraic factor one order past Lemma 16: $\frac{1}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} = 1 + \frac{u^2}{2} + R_2(u)$ with the Lagrange form $R_2 = \frac{3}{8}u^4(1 - \xi)^{-5/2}$, $\xi \in (0, u^2)$, so $0 \leq R_2 \leq \frac{3}{8}2^{5/2}u^4 \leq 2.13u^4$ there. The completed Gaussian moments are exact, $\int_0^\infty u^{2k} e^{-2zu^2} du = \frac{(2k-1)!!}{2(4z)^k} \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{2z}}$, and produce the displayed polynomial parts: for I_1 , $(1 - 2u^2)(1 + \frac{u^2}{2}) = 1 - \frac{3}{2}u^2 - u^4$ gives $1 - \frac{3}{8z} - \frac{3}{16z^2}$; for I_0 , $1 + \frac{u^2}{2}$ gives $1 + \frac{1}{8z}$. Four error sources, each explicit: (i) the R_2 term, at most $\frac{3}{8}2^{5/2} \cdot \frac{3}{16z^2} = \frac{0.398}{z^2}$ relative to the $k = 0$ moment (for I_1 multiplied further by $|1 - 2u^2| \leq 1$); (ii) the exact $-u^4$ moment of I_1 , $-\frac{3}{16z^2}$, absorbed into ε_1 with its sign; (iii) the Gaussian completion residues, bounded as in Lemma 16 by $\frac{3}{z}e^{-z}$ -scale terms; (iv) the segment $[\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, 1]$, bounded by $\sqrt{2}e^{-z}$ for I_0 ($\frac{1}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} \leq$

$\frac{\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2(1-u)}}$, integrable) and by $\frac{\pi}{4}e^{-z}$ for I_1 . At $z \geq 20$ the exponential sources (iii)–(iv) are below $10^{-3}/z^2$ against the prefactor $e^z/\sqrt{2\pi z}$; collecting, $|\varepsilon_1| \leq (0.398 + 0.188 + 10^{-3})/z^2 \leq 0.6/z^2$ and $|\varepsilon_0| \leq (0.398 + 10^{-3})/z^2 \leq 0.4/z^2$. Both truncations carry the correct next-order signatures ($-\frac{15}{128}z^{-2}$ for $\nu = 1$, $+\frac{9}{128}z^{-2}$ for $\nu = 0$; measured $\sup z^2|\varepsilon_1| = 0.1227$, $\sup z^2|\varepsilon_0| = 0.0743$): the inked constants are the derived chain's, the measurements are calibration only. For the three-term forms, one more order of the same expansion: $\frac{1}{\sqrt{1-u^2}} = 1 + \frac{u^2}{2} + \frac{3}{8}u^4 + R_3(u)$ with $R_3 = \frac{5}{16}u^6(1-\xi)^{-7/2} \leq \frac{5}{16}2^{7/2}u^6 \leq 3.54u^6$ on $[0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}]$; for I_1 , $(1-2u^2)(1+\frac{u^2}{2}+\frac{3}{8}u^4) = 1-\frac{3}{2}u^2-\frac{5}{8}u^4-\frac{3}{4}u^6$ gives $1 - \frac{3}{8z} - \frac{15}{128z^2} - \frac{45}{256z^3}$; the R_3 term contributes at most $3.54 \cdot \frac{15}{64z^3} \leq 0.83/z^3$, the exact $-\frac{45}{256}z^{-3}$ term $0.176/z^3$ with its sign, the exponential sources $10^{-2}/z^3$: $|\varepsilon_1^{(3)}| \leq 1.02/z^3$. For I_0 , $1 + \frac{u^2}{2} + \frac{3}{8}u^4$ gives $1 + \frac{1}{8z} + \frac{9}{128z^2}$ and $|\varepsilon_0^{(3)}| \leq (0.83 + 0.01)/z^3 \leq 0.84/z^3$. (Calibration: measured $z^3|\varepsilon_1^{(3)}| \leq 0.111$, $z^3|\varepsilon_0^{(3)}| \leq 0.080$ on $[20, 112]$ — factor 9 of chain headroom; bench transcript committed.) $\square$

Corollary 24 (exact; the measure ratio). *Define $r(z) := \frac{I_2(z)}{z I_1(z)}$, so that $H_B(z) = r(z) \frac{I_1(z)}{z} = r(z) \frac{K}{2\beta}$ pointwise. Then for $z \geq 20$,*

$$r(z) = \frac{1}{z} - \frac{3}{2z^2} + \eta(z), \quad |\eta(z)| \leq \frac{1.23}{z^3};$$

and, from the three-term companions,

$$\eta(z) = \frac{3}{8z^3} + \eta^{(4)}(z), \quad |\eta^{(4)}(z)| \leq \frac{2.5}{z^4}.$$

Proof. $r = \frac{1}{z} \frac{I_0}{I_1} - \frac{2}{z^2}$ by $I_2 = I_0 - 2I_1/z$ [4, 10.29.1]. By Lemma 23, with $a = \frac{1}{8z} + \varepsilon_0$ and $b = -\frac{3}{8z} + \varepsilon_1$, $\frac{I_0}{I_1} - 1 = \frac{a-b}{1+b}$, and $1+b \geq 1 - \frac{3}{160} - \frac{0.6}{400} \geq 0.9797$ at $z \geq 20$; hence $\frac{I_0}{I_1} = 1 + \frac{1}{2z} + \eta_2$ with

$$|\eta_2| = \left| \frac{(\varepsilon_0 - \varepsilon_1) - \frac{1}{2z}b}{1+b} \right| \leq \frac{\frac{1.0}{z^2} + \frac{3}{16z^2} + \frac{0.3}{z^3}}{0.9797} \leq \frac{1.23}{z^2},$$

and $r = \frac{1}{z}(1 + \frac{1}{2z} + \eta_2) - \frac{2}{z^2} = \frac{1}{z} - \frac{3}{2z^2} + \frac{\eta_2}{z}$. For the refined form, divide the three-term companions: $\frac{I_0}{I_1} = 1 + \frac{1}{2z} + \frac{3}{8z^2} + \eta'_3$ with $|\eta'_3| \leq (1.02 + 0.84 + 0.2)/(0.97z^3) \leq 2.13/z^3$ (the 0.2 collects the cubic cross-products of the two-term coefficients), whence $\eta = \frac{3}{8z^3} + \frac{\eta'_3}{z}$ and $|\eta^{(4)}| \leq 2.13/z^4 \leq 2.5/z^4$. (Calibration: measured $\sup_{z \in [20, 112]} z^3|\eta| = 0.395$ and $z^3\eta \rightarrow \frac{3}{8} = 0.375$ exactly as derived; measured $z^4|\eta^{(4)}| \leq 0.41$ — factor 6 of chain headroom.) $\square$

Lemma 25 (the bilinear saddle extraction). *Let $T(c) := \frac{4c^2 - 1}{8c^3}$ ($= [\frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{8c^2}]/c > 0$ on the relay range) and $s_4 := \sin(t/4)$, $\delta_4 := c - s_4 = \sqrt{2}\sin \frac{\pi-t}{4}$. Assume (H_{tail}) (the β^{-4} -tail hypothesis, stated in step (iv)(e) below). Then for $\beta \geq \beta_1 = 15$ and $t \in (0, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]$,*

$$\left| \frac{4\beta^3(\mu_D\nu_N - \mu_N\nu_D)}{\mu_D^2} - \frac{T(c)}{\beta} \right| \leq \frac{R_1(c)}{\beta^2} + M(c, \beta),$$

where $\mu_f = \iint Kf$, $\nu_f = \iint D H_B f$ (Convention 15), M is the explicit mirror bound of step (v) below, and

$$R_1(c) = |r_2(c)| + \frac{\Theta_3(c)}{\beta_1}, \quad r_2(c) = \frac{-8c^4 + 15c^2 - 4}{32c^6},$$

with Θ_3 the explicit β^{-3} -bucket constant of step (iv).

Proof. First line (the half-angle identity, cited). With $C = 2c^2 - 1$ (the half-angle law), the fluctuation $F = N - CD$ of Lemma 21(b) vanishes at the saddle $s = \alpha = 0$: $N(0, 0) = 2C = CD(0, 0)$. The bilinear form is invariant under $N \mapsto N - aD$ for constant a , so N is replaced by F throughout; every leading-order product then dies at the saddle, and the first surviving order carries the lemma.

(0) *Single measure.* By Corollary 24, $\nu_f = \frac{1}{2\beta} \langle D f r(z) \rangle$. Freezing $r_s := r(z_s)$ and writing $\Delta r := r(z) - r_s$ splits

$$\frac{4\beta^3(\mu_D \nu_F - \mu_F \nu_D)}{\mu_D^2} = \underbrace{\frac{2\beta^2 r_s [\langle D \rangle \langle DF \rangle - \langle F \rangle \langle D^2 \rangle]}{\langle D \rangle^2}}_{X_1} + \underbrace{\frac{2\beta^2 [\langle D \rangle \langle DF \Delta r \rangle - \langle F \rangle \langle D^2 \Delta r \rangle]}{\langle D \rangle^2}}_{X_2},$$

five moments of polynomial weights and one deficit weight, all under the single measure K .

(i) *The deficit chart.* $R^2 = 4c^2(1-w)$ with $w := P+Q-PQ/c^2$ exactly, so $z = z_s \sqrt{1-w}$; on the relay range $0 \leq w \leq 1$ (Lemma 21(a)), and on the saddle ball $\{w \leq \frac{1}{2}\}$ every kernel prefactor is a $(1-w)$ -power with two-sided binomial bounds (the bilateral root floor: for $0 \leq w \leq \frac{1}{2}$, $1 - \frac{w}{2} - \frac{w^2}{4} \leq \sqrt{1-w} \leq 1 - \frac{w}{2}$, and the $-\frac{3}{4}, -\frac{1}{2}, -1$ powers likewise, each with its Lagrange constant at $w = \frac{1}{2}$).

(ii) *Saddle chart and extraction.* With $s = \sigma/\sqrt{\beta}$, $\alpha = \tau/\sqrt{\beta}$, the exponent $z - z_s + \frac{c}{2}(\sigma^2 + \tau^2)$ has *identically vanishing* constant term (the Gaussian $e^{-c\rho^2/2}$ is exact at leading order), and each of the five moments expands in $1/\beta$ with polynomial-Gaussian coefficients whose remainder constants come from three named sources only: Lemma 23 (kernel correction and ε_1), Corollary 24 (r_s and η), and the root floor of (i). The Gaussian moments are exact. The assembled coefficients were extracted symbolically and machine-verified twice with independent truncation depths (scripts `derive_page_pass2.py` and the audit's independent rebuild, archived with transcripts; the extraction is protected not by a blanket truncation ceiling but by the *asserted structural zeros* — the exponent's vanishing constant term, Gaussian parity, the bracket zeros at orders β^0 and $\beta^{-1/2}$ — together with the structural minima $F = O(\beta^{-1})$, $\Delta r = O(\beta^{-2})$):

$$\beta X_1 \longrightarrow 2T(c), \quad \beta X_2 \longrightarrow -T(c) \quad \text{symbolically,}$$

with next coefficients $r_{2,1}(c) = \frac{-44c^4+29c^2-6}{32c^6}$, $r_{2,2}(c) = \frac{18c^4-7c^2+1}{16c^6}$, and the sum telescopes to

$$\frac{4\beta^3(\mu_D \nu_N - \mu_N \nu_D)}{\mu_D^2} = \frac{T(c)}{\beta} + \frac{r_2(c)}{\beta^2} + \rho_3, \quad r_2 = r_{2,1} + r_{2,2},$$

on the saddle ball, with ρ_3 collected in (iv).

(iii) *Why the split is not cosmetic.* X_1 carries the frozen ratio: its bracket is the pure covariance whose leading cancellation is the identity of the first line — no absolute-value route survives it (the measured $\times 500$ loss of the crude covariance bound). X_2 carries the ratio variation in the deficit weight Δr , two-sidedly controlled by the root floor. The two targets $2T$ and $-T$ were pre-registered as intermediate judges with closed forms and verified independently *before* this page was written; their integer proportion is the fingerprint of the single carrier.

(iv) *The remainder ρ_3 , by named source — every term of order β^{-3} .* (a) ε_1 enters every K -moment through the common factor $1 - \frac{3}{8z} + \varepsilon_1$; its *constant* part $\varepsilon_1(z_s)$ cancels exactly in both quotients (numerators and denominators are homogeneous of degree two in the moments),

so only its variation over the ball survives — and the variation now has its *witness*: with $g_1 := z^2 \varepsilon_1 = -\frac{15}{128} + z^2 \varepsilon_1^{(3)}$ (three-term companion),

$$|\varepsilon_1(z) - \varepsilon_1(z_s)| \leq \frac{|g_1(z) - g_1(z_s)|}{z^2} + |g_1(z_s)| \left| \frac{1}{z^2} - \frac{1}{z_s^2} \right| \leq \frac{4.94}{z_s^3} + \frac{0.34 w}{z_s^2}$$

on $\{w \leq \frac{1}{2}\}$ ($|g_1 + \frac{15}{128}| \leq 1.02/z$, $(1-w)^{-1} - 1 \leq 2w$, $1/z^2 \leq 2/z_s^2$): a β^{-3} perturbation of βX with constant $\leq 0.5/c^3$ (both pieces). (b) the frozen tail $\eta(z_s)$ is a relative perturbation $|\eta_s| z_s \leq 1.23/z_s^2$ of r_s , hence perturbs $\beta X_1 \approx 2T$ by at most $\frac{0.154 T(c)}{c^2} \beta^{-2}$ on βX , i.e. at β^{-3} on the normalized object. (c) the deficit tail, witnessed by the refined ratio of Corollary 24:

$$\Delta\eta = \frac{3}{8z_s^3} [(1-w)^{-3/2} - 1] + \Delta\eta^{(4)}, \quad |\Delta\eta| \leq \frac{1.37 w}{z_s^3} + \frac{12.5}{z_s^4}$$

(($(1-w)^{-3/2} - 1 \leq 3.66 w$ and $(1-w)^{-2} \leq 4$ on $[0, \frac{1}{2}]$): at most $\frac{0.95 T(c)}{c^2} \beta^{-2}$ on βX_2 , the two pieces at the Gaussian w -moment and absolutely. (d) the ball's Gaussian tails and the ring and far regions are the two templated families of Lemma 11, exponentially below every polynomial source. (e) the saddle chain's own next polynomial coefficient, extracted by the same machinery one order deeper (with the kernel's next companion order $-\frac{15}{128} z^{-2}$ carried; the β^0 and β^{-1} coefficients are unchanged by it — re-verified):

$$r_3(c) = \frac{-12c^6 - 485c^4 + 796c^2 - 224}{1024 c^9},$$

whose judge-cell values $+0.0844, +0.1762, +0.3264, +0.5601$ independently match the audit's measured Richardson drifts (0.112, 0.177, —, 0.572 at the three audited t 's). Collecting,

$$\Theta_3(c) = |r_3(c)| + \frac{1.10 T(c)}{c^2} + \frac{0.5}{c^3} + 0.05,$$

and $R_1 = |r_2| + \Theta_3/\beta_1$ evaluates on the four judge cells ($c = 0.99, 0.93, 0.87, 0.81$) to 0.172, 0.233, 0.313, 0.411 — inside the pre-registered acceptance band [residual, $3 \times$ residual] at every cell (residuals 0.101–0.292, bands $[0.101, 0.303] \dots [0.292, 0.876]$), while r_2 alone reproduces the measured residual table: $+0.1001, +0.1444, +0.1996, +0.2653$. One debt, declared and carried as the hypothesis the statement assumes: writing $\tau(\beta, c)$ for the β^{-4} -and-beyond chain tail (not separately extracted; it depends on c through the same chains), the display holds *unconditionally* with R_1/β^2 replaced by $R_1/\beta^2 + |\tau(\beta, c)|$, and the statement's assumption is exactly

$$(H_{\text{tail}}): \quad |\tau(\beta, c)| \leq \frac{\Theta_3(c)}{\beta_1 \beta^2} \quad \text{for } \beta \geq \beta_1, t \in (0, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]$$

— i.e. the tail is absorbed by the same Θ_3 headroom its Lagrange forms ride; (H_{tail}) is the lemma's one open obligation, echoed in Remark 26 and in the relay table, and the campaign's certified boxes cover $[6, 15]$ independently of it.

(*v*) *The mirror clause.* Under the involution of Remark 20, $T(s, \alpha) = (\pi - s, \pi - \alpha)$: $D \circ T = -D$, $N \circ T = C(2x^2 - 1) + y(Cx + 1 - x^2)$ (its own object: only the $-1 + x^2$ block flips sign), $|F \circ T| \leq 5$, and $R^2(\cdot; c) \circ T = R^2(\cdot; s_4)$ *exactly*: every mirror-region moment is a saddle-chart moment at parameter s_4 , with exact relative suppression $e^{-4\beta\delta_4}$. Moreover

$$C = 2c^2 - 1 = (c - s_4)(c + s_4) = \delta_4(c + s_4)$$

— the half-angle key once more — so the mirror terms carrying C are uniformly tamed by $\sup_{x>0} x e^{-4x} = \frac{1}{4e}$. For $s_4 \geq \frac{1}{2}$ ($t \geq \frac{2\pi}{3}$; this zone contains the stress cell) the s_4 -saddle mass obeys the derived Gaussian upper bound $\Lambda(s_4)\beta^{-3/2}e^{4\beta s_4}$ with $\Lambda(s_4) = 1.34 s_4^{-5/2}$ (the chain constant $1.08/q(s_4)$ with $q = 1 - \frac{0.0492}{s_4^2}$ evaluated at the zone edge $s_4 = \frac{1}{2}$; at the stress cell the local value is 1.21) [chain: $K \leq 2\beta e^z/(\sqrt{2\pi}z^{3/2})$ for $z \geq 20$ from Lemma 23; $z \geq z_s(s_4)/\sqrt{2} \geq 21$ on the ball at $\beta \geq 15$ by the root floor; $e^{z-z_s(s_4)} \leq e^{-2\beta s_4 \tilde{w}}$ with $\tilde{w} \geq (1 - \frac{0.0492}{s_4^2})(P' + Q')$ and $P' \geq 0.2458 s'^2$ on the ball — bench: dominates the true mirror-ball mass by $\times 2.7$ at the stress cell], and the Gaussian ρ'^2 -moment ratio is $\leq 4.7/(\beta s_4)$. With the corner expansion $|F \circ T - 4C| \leq 6\rho'^2$ (Hessian sup), $r(z(\cdot; s_4)) \leq \sqrt{2}/(4\beta s_4)$ on the ball, and the main-side bounds $\nu_D \leq 0.715 \mu_D/(\beta^2 c)$, $|\nu_F| \leq 12.09 \mu_D/(\beta^3 c^2)$, $|\mu_F| \leq 34.2 \mu_D/(\beta c)$ (all from the $\langle P \rangle$ -chain $P \leq 1.11 w$ on the ball, $D \geq 1.8$ there, and Lemma 11 off it), the four cross terms and the second-order term assemble to the *fully derived* bound

$$M(c, \beta) = \frac{\Lambda(s_4)}{m_*} \left[\left(\frac{4\sqrt{2}}{s_4} + \frac{11.44}{c} \right) (c + s_4) \beta \delta_4 + \frac{39.9}{s_4^2} + \frac{96.7}{c^2} + \frac{96.7}{c s_4} + \frac{80.7}{c s_4} \right] e^{-4\beta \delta_4} \\ + \frac{10\sqrt{2}}{s_4} \left(\frac{\Lambda(s_4)}{m_*} \right)^2 \beta e^{-8\beta \delta_4}$$

for $s_4 \geq \frac{1}{2}$, while for $s_4 < \frac{1}{2}$ (where $\delta_4 \geq 0.366$) the crude global bounds $K \leq \beta e^{z(\cdot; s_4)}$ ($A \leq \frac{1}{2}$) and $H_B \leq K/(8\beta)$ (Lemma 11) give $M \leq \frac{92}{m_*^2} \beta^{9/2} e^{-4\beta \delta_4} \leq 2.1 \times 10^{-2}$, decreasing on $\beta \geq 15$. Throughout, $m_* \geq \frac{1}{2}$ is Lemma 19 (the signed minoration, discharged): M is unconditional, as is Corollary 14.

Stress-cell accounting, stated plainly. At the pre-registered stress cell $(t, \beta) = (2.9, 15)$ the five term bounds evaluate to $4.74 + 7.71 + 8.70 + 8.49 + 0.64 = 30.3$, each verified to dominate its true mirror-ball counterpart by direct quadrature (bench transcript committed; true term sum 0.0733, consistent with the measured net mirror -0.0707): the bound holds, the saddle piece $+0.023553$ matches $T(c)/\beta = +0.024661$ with the normal residual, but M sits a factor ≈ 428 above the truth — outside the $\times 10$ template class the pre-registration anticipated. The identified fat, by source: the crude ν_F chain ($\times 81$; sharpens to $\times 2$ via the extracted leading coefficient), the unconditional μ_F chain ($\times 58$; the Step-0 window — first client of the mechanical cascade — delivers $\times 10$), the corner Hessian and mass-template constants ($\times 2$ – 3 each). The $\times 10$ -class mirror clause is thus a *named, mechanical* refinement — the mirror-chart extraction at parameter s_4 with the same audited machinery — queued with the cascade; the campaign range independently receives certificate-grade per-box mirror enclosures from the coverage machinery, which subsumes this clause on [6, 15]. $\square$

Remark 26 (status and tricotomy of the extraction). The closed forms $2T$, $-T$, $r_{2,1}$, $r_{2,2}$, r_3 are *exact* (symbolic extraction with proved-zero asserts, machine-verified twice at independent truncation depths; trust base `sympy`, the `derive_holonomic` precedent). The remainder constants of (iv)–(v) are *exact* consequences of Lemmas 23, 24 (including the three-term witnesses for the variation constants) and the root floor; M 's normalization by the saddle-mass floor is Lemma 19 (unconditional), and the β^{-4} chain tail is the explicit open hypothesis (H_{tail}) of step (iv)(e): until it is discharged, the extraction lemma's use on the relay is conditional on it, and the relay table says so. The residual table, the stress-cell pieces, and the independent Richardson verification (targets hit to relative 10^{-6} at three t 's, drift-halving ratios ≈ 2.00) are *verified* numerics, quoted as calibration of the pre-registered judges, bearing no load in the bound.

Proposition 27 (certified; local box: $(t, \beta) \in [1.5, 1.51] \times [8, 8.05]$). *For every $(t, \beta) \in [1.5, 1.51] \times [8, 8.05]$ one has $\langle D \rangle > 0$ and $W_c < 0$; hence, by Lemma 6, $E'(t, \beta) < 0$ on this box.*

Certificate. Ball-arithmetic machine certificate (python-flint 0.9.0 / Arb). The executed script is identified by SHA-256 prefix `1d888e99` and is archived byte-exact in the repository, together with the self-contained transcript (both file names carry the hash; the transcript’s provenance header records the full hash, library versions, and stage parameters). Three stages, one transcript. *Point* (1.5, 8): 1,951,141 cells, $W_c/\langle D \rangle^2 \subset [-0.4546, -0.1752]$. *Stability* (precision 120, $\Delta z \leq 0.12$): 2,500,336 cells, ratio $\subset [-0.4304, -0.1978]$, nested inside the point enclosure. *Box*: union of nine parametric sub-boxes ($\Delta\beta \leq 0.02$, $\Delta t \leq 0.005$), each with strictly negative W_c enclosure and $\langle D \rangle > 0$ (worst W_c upper end $\leq -2.8 \times 10^{21}$), 22,986,387 cells in total, 7558 s. All comparisons are strict ball comparisons; the displayed intervals are outward-rounded supersets of the printed enclosures. This proposition validates the mechanism and calibrates the coverage design; it does *not* close the [6, 15] row, which stays open until the full region $6 \leq \beta \leq 15$, $0.6 \leq t \leq \pi - 1.5/\beta$ is covered. $\square$

Remark 28 (what certifies, and what audits). The mathematical certificate for each sub-box is its *single* rigorous Arb enclosure: outward-rounded ball arithmetic makes one honest enclosure a proof of the strict inequalities, per sub-box. The precision-120 stability stage (with its nesting inside the point enclosure) and the *planned* pre-registered sampled `mpmath.iv` reproduction are *implementation audits*: they test the software that produced the enclosures, not the inequalities themselves, and they are declared as such in the relay table. This fixes the convention for the [6, 15] coverage: one certificate-grade Arb enclosure per sub-box; stability and sampling audit the pipeline.

Lemma 29 (safe square roots in the archived run). *In the archived script (SHA-256 `1d888e99`), the square-root guard clamps a negative lower endpoint to 0 and, when the upper endpoint ball straddles 0, returns the dyadic upper bound $2^{8-p/2}$ at working precision $p \geq 90$. This bound is valid throughout the run. Indeed, the guarded inputs are true squares: $R^2 = 4[c_0^2(1-P-Q)+PQ]$ with $c_0^2 \leq 1$, $P, Q \in [0, 1]$, and $z^2 = 4\beta^2 R^2$ with $\beta \leq 15$, so $|R^2| \leq 16$, $|z^2| \leq 14400$; the corresponding balls are built by at most twelve correctly rounded operations on factors of unit size, hence $|R_{\text{ball}}^2| < 16.01$ and $|z_{\text{ball}}^2| < 14401 < 2^{14}$ (magnitude means $|\text{mid}| + \text{rad}$). The upper-endpoint ball $u = \text{mid} + \text{rad}$ involves two exact *arf-to-ball* conversions and one correctly rounded addition, so $\text{rad}(u) \leq \text{ulp}(2^{14}) = 2^{15-p}$. If u straddles 0 then $|\text{mid}(u)| \leq \text{rad}(u)$, hence the true upper endpoint is at most $2\text{rad}(u) \leq 2^{16-p}$ and its square root is at most $2^{8-p/2}$ — exactly the coded constant. (In the definitive script the branch is replaced by `abs_upper()`, an automatic outer bound with no ad-hoc constant; the present lemma covers the archived run.)*

The two scaled functions

The certificate’s precision rests on three one-line facts. (a) $A(z) = e^{-z}I_1(z)/z$ is strictly decreasing on $(0, \infty)$: by the classical lower bound $I_{\nu+1}(z)/I_\nu(z) \geq z/(\nu+1 + \sqrt{(\nu+1)^2 + z^2})$, valid for $z > 0$ and $\nu \geq 0$ (Amos [1]; both members of the classical two-sided pair are proved in [2], Theorem 1), taken at $\nu = 0$, together with $\sqrt{1+z^2} \leq z+1$ (square both sides), $I_1/I_0 > z/(z+2)$, which is exactly $(\log A)' = I_0/I_1 - 1 - 2/z < 0$; hence A is enclosed over any z -interval by its two endpoint values. (b) The kernel-score product collapses algebraically, $K \partial_t \log K = 32\beta^3 \cos(t/4)(\cos(t/4))'(1-P-Q) H_B(z)$ (the factor $I_1(z)/z$ cancels between K and the denominator of the regular score), so the covariance integrands involve only

$B(z) = e^{-z} H_B(z)$. (c) B is enclosed *unconditionally* by $[e^{-z_{\text{hi}}} H_B(z_{\text{lo}}), e^{-z_{\text{lo}}} H_B(z_{\text{hi}})]$, since e^{-z} decreases and H_B (a positive-coefficient entire series) increases; after centering, the B -terms are subdominant and this crude-but-safe bound suffices. Together with the exact linear-exponential cell integrals, every source of exponential interval growth is either integrated analytically or carried by a monotone one-dimensional profile — the certificate is structure, not brute force.

3 The spectral framework

Convention 30 (normalizations). On $(0, \pi)$ define the kernel, entry law, and smoothing operator

$$q_1(u, v) = 2 e^{\beta \cos u \cos v} \sinh(\beta \sin u \sin v) = 4 \sum_{m \geq 1} I_m \sin(mu) \sin(mv), \quad (3)$$

$$s_1(u) = \frac{\beta}{2} \sin u e^{\beta \cos u} = \sum_{m \geq 1} m I_m \sin(mu), \quad (4)$$

$$(Qf)(v) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^\pi q_1(v, u) f(u) du, \quad (5)$$

so that $Q \sin(m \cdot) = I_m \sin(m \cdot)$. Both closed forms are classical consequences of the generating function $e^{\beta \cos \theta} = I_0 + 2 \sum_{m \geq 1} I_m \cos(m\theta)$; (4) follows by differentiation. All ten verification artifacts in the repository use exactly these normalizations.

Since $q_1 > 0$ on $(0, \pi)^2$ and $s_1 > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$, the walk with step kernel q_1 killed on $\{0, \pi\}$ is well defined; $H(\psi) = \beta \sin(\psi/2) I_1(2\beta \cos(\psi/2))$ and $K_2(\varphi) = I_0(2\beta \cos(\varphi/2))$ appear below. Note $F_B = Q^3 s_1$ and, by the sine orthogonality computation of Lemma 37, F_A is the companion cosine-weighted integral.

4 Theorem A: positivity of F_B

Theorem 31 (exact). $F_B(t) > 0$ for all $t \in (0, \pi)$ and all $\beta > 0$.

First proof (kernel positivity). $F_B = Q^3 s_1$ by (5) and $b_m = m I_m^4$. Each application of Q integrates a positive function against the strictly positive kernel (3); $s_1 > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$. Hence $F_B > 0$ pointwise. $\square$

Second proof (symmetric-decreasing convolution). With $K_2(\varphi) = I_0(2\beta \cos(\varphi/2))$ and $P_4 = K_2 * K_2$ (circle convolution; Section 7), $F_B = -\frac{1}{2} P_4'$. The function K_2 is even and *strictly decreasing in $|\varphi|$ on $[0, \pi]$* (I_0 strictly increasing, $\cos(\varphi/2)$ strictly decreasing). By the layer-cake representation, $K_2 = \int_0^\infty \mathbf{1}_{A_\lambda} d\lambda$ with A_λ centered arcs whose half-lengths $a(\lambda)$ fill $(0, \pi)$ continuously (strict decrease). For centered arcs, $(\mathbf{1}_A * \mathbf{1}_B)(t) = |A \cap (t + B)|$ is even and nonincreasing in $|t|$ on $[0, \pi]$, and *strictly decreasing on $||a - b|, \min(a + b, 2\pi - a - b)|$* . Hence $P_4(t) = \iint |A_\lambda \cap (t + A_\mu)| d\lambda d\mu$ is even, nonincreasing on $[0, \pi]$, and strictly decreasing on $(0, \pi)$ because for every $t \in (0, \pi)$ a positive measure of pairs (λ, μ) has $|a(\lambda) - a(\mu)| < t < \min(a + b, 2\pi - a - b)$ (the half-lengths fill $(0, \pi)$). At the derivative level: each overlap $t \mapsto |A_\lambda \cap (t + A_\mu)|$ is Lipschitz with a.e. derivative -1 in the strict regime and 0 otherwise (on $[0, \pi]$); since P_4 is analytic, dominated convergence gives $P_4'(t) = \iint \partial_t |A_\lambda \cap (t + A_\mu)| d\lambda d\mu \leq -\mu\{(\lambda, \mu) : \text{strict at } t\} < 0$ pointwise on $(0, \pi)$. Thus $F_B = -\frac{1}{2} P_4' > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$. $\square$

5 Theorem B: ratio monotonicity for $0 < \beta \leq 3$

Lemma 32 (exact; Wronskian identity). *For real arrays with $\sum m(|a_m| + |b_m|) < \infty$,*

$$W := 2(F'_A F_B - F_A F'_B) = \sum_{1 \leq m < n} c_{mn} T_{mn}(t), \quad c_{mn} = a_m b_n - a_n b_m, \quad (6)$$

where $T_{mn}(t) = (m - n) \sin((m + n)t) + (m + n) \sin((n - m)t)$.

Proof. Product-to-sum: $T_{mn} = 2[m \cos(mt) \sin(nt) - n \sin(mt) \cos(nt)] =: 2G(m, n)$, antisymmetric with $G(n, n) = 0$; since c_{mn} is antisymmetric, $\sum_{m < n} c_{mn} 2G = 2 \sum_{m, n} a_m b_n G(m, n) = 2[F'_A F_B - F_A F'_B]$ (first recorded in [7]). $\square$

The coefficient input is the weighted Turán-type lemma (Appendix A, self-contained): $\varphi_m = a_m/b_m$ is strictly increasing in $m \geq 1$ for every $\beta > 0$, hence *every minor is negative*: $c_{mn} < 0$ for $m < n$ (exact).

Lemma 33 (exact; the pair identities and bounds). *For $t \in (0, \pi)$, with $p = n - m$, $q = n + m$:*

$$(a) \quad T_{12} = 4 \sin^3 t; \quad T_{13} = 16 \sin^3 t \cos t; \quad T_{24} = 8 \sin^3(2t), \quad \text{so } |T_{13}| \leq 16 \sin^3 t \text{ and } |T_{24}| \leq 64 \sin^3 t.$$

$$(b) \quad T_{m, m+1} \geq 0 \text{ for every } m \geq 1.$$

$$(c) \quad |T_{mn}| \leq \frac{\pi^3}{48} pq(q^2 + p^2) \sin^3 t \text{ for all } m < n.$$

Proof. (a) $3 \sin u - \sin 3u = 4 \sin^3 u$ gives T_{12} (at $u = t$) and T_{24} (at $u = 2t$); $T_{13} = 4 \sin 2t - 2 \sin 4t = 4 \sin 2t(1 - \cos 2t) = 16 \sin^3 t \cos t$. (b) $T_{m, m+1} = (2m + 1) \sin t - \sin((2m + 1)t) \geq 0$ since $|\sin(qt)| \leq q \sin t$ on $(0, \pi)$ (induction on q). (c) T_{mn} and its first two derivatives vanish at $t = 0$ and $t = \pi$ (the parities of $m \pm n$ agree), and $|T'''_{mn}| \leq pq^3 + qp^3 = pq(q^2 + p^2)$; hence $|T_{mn}(t)| \leq \frac{pq(q^2 + p^2)}{6} \min(t, \pi - t)^3$, and $\sin t \geq \frac{2}{\pi} \min(t, \pi - t)$ gives the claim. $\square$

Theorem 34 (exact modulo the certified computation `certify_thmB.py`). *For $0 < \beta \leq 3$: $W < 0$ on $(0, \pi)$, hence $E' < 0$ on $(0, \pi)$.*

Proof. Drop the adjacent pairs $m \geq 2$ (each contributes $c_{m, m+1} T_{m, m+1} \leq 0$ by Lemma 33(b) and $c < 0$); keep T_{12} , T_{13} , T_{24} exactly and majorize every other pair by Lemma 33(c). Pointwise in t ,

$$\frac{W(t)}{\sin^3 t} \leq \text{Crit}(\beta) := -4|c_{12}| + 16|c_{13}| + 64|c_{24}| + \frac{\pi^3}{48} \sum_{\substack{p \geq 2 \\ (m, n) \neq (1, 3), (2, 4)}} pq(q^2 + p^2) |c_{mn}|.$$

The certificate `certify_thmB.py` (Section 10) encloses Crit in interval arithmetic over adaptive β -boxes covering $[1/20, 3]$ (I_m increasing in β gives rigorous boxes; cutoff $M = 60$ with the tail itself computed in intervals and closed by a derived, per-box-asserted geometric ratio) and certifies $\text{Crit} < 0$ on all of $[1/20, 3]$; the script then re-certifies *every* box at precision +70 before reporting success (the box count is invocation- and implementation-dependent; the independent Arb implementation `certify_thmB_arb.py` certifies the same coverage with 86 boxes and a full stability pass, transcript archived). For $0 < \beta \leq 1/20$, Lemma 35 applies. $\square$

Lemma 35 (exact; small β). For $0 < \beta \leq 1/20$: $\text{Crit}(\beta) < 0$.

Proof. Write $\kappa = \beta/2 \leq 1/40$, $L_m = \kappa^m/m!$, $U_m = e^* L_m$ with $e^* = e^{\beta^2/4} \leq e^{1/1600} < 1.001$; then $L_m \leq I_m \leq U_m$ (positive series). *Leading minor:* $a_2 b_1 \geq (I_1^2 I_2^2)(I_1^4) \geq L_1^6 L_2^2 = \kappa^{10}/4$ and $a_1 b_2 = (2I_1^2 I_2^2)(2I_2^4) \leq 4U_1^2 U_2^6 = (e^*)^8 \kappa^{14}/16$, so

$$|c_{12}| \geq \frac{\kappa^{10}}{4} \left(1 - \frac{(e^*)^8 \kappa^4}{4}\right) \geq \frac{\kappa^{10}}{4} (1 - 10^{-6}).$$

The three visible positive terms: $a_3 \leq I_3^2 \cdot (2I_2^2 + 4I_4^2) \leq (e^*)^4 \kappa^{10}/24 \cdot (1 + 10^{-4})$ and $b_1 \leq (e^*)^4 \kappa^4$ give $16|c_{13}| \leq 16(a_3 b_1 + a_1 b_3) \leq 0.70 \kappa^{14}$; $64|c_{24}| \leq 64(a_4 b_2 + a_2 b_4) \leq 10^{-3} \kappa^{14}$ (both products have κ -degree ≥ 22); the largest remaining weighted pair is $(1, 4)$: $\frac{\pi^3}{48} \cdot 510 \cdot (a_4 b_1 + a_1 b_4) \leq 0.2 \kappa^{18} \leq 10^{-6} \kappa^{14}$. *All other pairs* (those with $s := m + n \geq 6$, $p \geq 2$): using $a_n b_m + a_m b_n \leq 2mn(e^*)^8 \kappa^{4s-2} [((m-1)!m!)^{-2} n!^{-4} + ((n-1)!n!)^{-2} m!^{-4}] \leq s^2 (e^*)^8 \kappa^{4s-2}$ (the factorial bracket is ≤ 2 and $2mn \leq s^2/2$), $pq(q^2 + p^2) \leq 2s^4$, and at most s pairs per level,

$$\frac{\pi^3}{48} \sum_{s \geq 6} (\text{level } s) \leq \frac{\pi^3}{48} (e^*)^8 \sum_{s \geq 6} 2s^7 \kappa^{4s-2} \leq 0.66 \kappa^{22} \cdot 6^7 \sum_{j \geq 0} [(7/6)^7 \kappa^4]^j \leq 3.7 \times 10^5 \kappa^{22} \leq 10^{-7} \kappa^{14},$$

where the level ratio $s \mapsto s + 1$ is at most $(7/6)^7 \kappa^4 < 10^{-5} < \frac{1}{2}$ (so the geometric closure is valid), and $\kappa^8 \leq 40^{-8}$ absorbs the constant. Collecting:

$$\text{Crit} \leq -\kappa^{10}(1 - 10^{-6}) + 0.71 \kappa^{14} = -\kappa^{10}(1 - 10^{-6} - 0.71 \kappa^4) < 0,$$

since $\kappa^4 \leq 40^{-4} < 4 \cdot 10^{-7}$. (All numbered constants above are crude upper counts; each step loses factors, none gains.) $\square$

Remark 36 (verified; the sharp family and saturation). The sharper per-pair bound $|T_{mn}| \leq \frac{pq(q^2-p^2)}{6} \sin^3 t$ and the adjacent floor $T_{m,m+1} \geq 2m \sin^3 t$ (note the sign: the floor is a *lower* bound on a positive quantity) are verified far beyond the range used ($q \leq 151$; 13 pairs to $(10, 30)$, max ratio 1.0) and would extend Theorem 34 to $\beta \approx 3.5$; their per-pair certification is a scheduled upgrade. Beyond that the decomposition is *saturated*: with the exact far block (cancellation included) the criterion fails at $\beta = 6$ by $+2.2 \times 10^{14}$ while the true $W/\sin^3 t$ remains negative (-6.9×10^{12}) — a verified adversarial finding about the method, and the reason the large- β closure uses different machinery (Sections 7–9).

6 The bridge structure of E (exact)

Let $k = q_1 \circ q_1$ denote the two-step kernel, $k(\psi, t) = 4 \sum_{m \geq 1} I_m^2 \sin(m\psi) \sin(mt)$, and define

$$\omega_t(d\psi) \propto (Qs_1)(\psi) k(\psi, t) d\psi \quad \text{on } (0, \pi), \quad (7)$$

the law of the time-2 position (midpoint) of the four-step bridge entering from 0 with law s_1 and conditioned to end at t .

Lemma 37 (exact). $\int_0^\pi (Qs_1) k(\cdot, t) d\psi = 2\pi F_B(t)$ and $\int_0^\pi \cos \psi (Qs_1) k(\cdot, t) d\psi = \pi F_A(t)$.

Hence, as an identity,

$$E(t) = \mathbb{E}_{\omega_t}[\cos \psi] = \frac{F_A(t)}{2F_B(t)}.$$

Proof. $(Qs_1)(\psi) = \sum m I_m^2 \sin(m\psi)$. By sine orthogonality the first integral picks the diagonal, giving $2\pi \sum m I_m^4 \sin(mt)$. In the second, $\cos \psi \sin(m\psi) \sin(n\psi)$ integrates to $\frac{\pi}{4}(\delta_{n,m+1} + \delta_{n,m-1})$, which produces exactly the weights $(n-1)I_{n-1}^2 + (n+1)I_{n+1}^2$ of a_n . $\square$

Corollary 38 (exact; $|E| < 1$). *For all $t \in (0, \pi)$ and $\beta > 0$, $|E(t, \beta)| < 1$. Indeed $q_1(u, v) = 2e^{\beta \cos u \cos v} \sinh(\beta \sin u \sin v) > 0$ on $(0, \pi)^2$ and $s_1 > 0$, so $(Qs_1) > 0$ and $k = q_1 \circ q_1 > 0$ on $(0, \pi)$; hence ω_t in (7) is a genuine probability measure and $E = \mathbb{E}_{\omega_t}[\cos \psi] \in (-1, 1)$.*

Lemma 39 (exact; entry law). $\partial_t k(0^+, \psi) = 2H(\psi)$, where $H(\psi) = \beta \sin(\psi/2) I_1(2\beta \cos(\psi/2))$.

Proof. Differentiate in ψ the squared Graf identity $I_0^2 + 2 \sum_{m \geq 1} I_m^2 \cos(m\psi) = I_0(2\beta \cos(\psi/2))$ [4, §10.23(ii)] and compare with $\partial_t k(0^+, \psi) = 4 \sum m I_m^2 \sin(m\psi)$. $\square$

Proposition 40 (certified negative; no monotone full-path coupling). *At $\beta = 20$ the time-3 marginal $\rho_t(u) \propto (Q^2 s_1)(u) q_1(u, t)$ is not stochastically monotone in t : with $a = \frac{4802}{10^4}$, $t_1 = \frac{29621}{10^4}$, $t_2 = \frac{30070}{10^4}$, the tail masses satisfy $T(t_2, a) < T(t_1, a)$, with certified enclosure*

$$T(t_2, a) - T(t_1, a) \in [-2.5299150980081786690028107, -2.5299150980081786690028074] \times 10^{-10}.$$

Consequently no monotone coupling of full bridge paths exists at $\beta = 20$. The certificate uses exact termwise tails ($J(m, n, a) = \int_a^\pi \sin mu \sin nu du$ in closed form: no quadrature error), positive-series Bessel enclosures with geometric tails, explicit truncation bounds, nested passes $(M, \text{prec}) = (120, 350) \subset (140, 500)$, and two independent interval implementations (`mpmath.iv`; `Arb` via `python-flint`).

Proposition 41 (certified negatives; the weight–kernel matrix). *At $\beta = 20$, for every entry weight $Q^{k-1} s_1$ ($k = 1, 2, 3, 4$) the marginal one q_1 -step from the moving endpoint fails stochastic monotonicity, with certified witnesses sharing $(t_1, t_2) = (3, 61/20)$: $k = 1$ (two-step bridge midpoint, the minimal counterexample), $a = 9/10$, margin $\approx -1.34 \times 10^{-2}$; $k = 2$, $a = 3/4$, $\approx -1.80 \times 10^{-6}$; $k = 4$, $a = 3/10$, $\approx -4.75 \times 10^{-13}$ ($k = 3$ is Proposition 40). Two smoothing steps repair all tested weights (verified); one never does. The statement is relative to the natural weight family: k_2 possesses its own total-positivity corner ($\beta \gtrsim 8$) reachable by two-atom adversarial weights.*

Lemma 42 (exact; the 3/2 mechanism). $\lim_{u \downarrow 0} \frac{\partial_u \partial_t \log q_1(u, t)}{\beta \sin t u} = 1 + \frac{2\beta}{3} \cos t$. *For $t > \pi/2$ the corner sign change of $\partial_u \partial_t \log q_1$ occurs exactly when $|\beta| \cos t| > 3/2$ — the same threshold as the TP_2 failure of q_1 .*

Proof. $\partial_t \log q_1 = -\beta \sin t \cos u + \beta \cos t \sin u \coth(\beta \sin t \sin u)$ (direct differentiation of (3)); expand $\coth z = z^{-1} + z/3 + O(z^3)$ and differentiate in u ; the stated limit is a one-line computation (symbolic residual zero). $\square$

Remark 43 (verified; the mechanism reading). The identification of this local defect as *the* engine of Propositions 40–41 — sine-type entry weights, vanishing linearly at 0 with mass on both sides of the non-monotone region, flip the covariance $\text{Cov}_{\rho_t}(\mathbf{1}_{u \geq a}, \partial_t \log q_1)$, while the flat weight does not — is supported by the full weight–kernel matrix and the β -scan of the violations (onset at $\beta \gtrsim 12$, consistent with the threshold), but is a verified reading, not a theorem.

7 The single-Bessel reduction and the master formula

Lemma 44 (exact; Neumann product formulas). *For $x, y \geq 0$, with $w = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2 + 2xy \cos \alpha}$,*

$$I_0(x)I_0(y) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} I_0(w) d\alpha, \quad I_0(x)I_1(y) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} I_1(w) \frac{y + x \cos \alpha}{w} d\alpha.$$

Proof. The first is the integrated Graf/Neumann addition theorem [4, §10.23(ii)]; the second is its ∂_y -derivative. $\square$

Remark 45 (signs). Both formulas extend to all real x, y , as used below (on $[-\pi, \pi]^2$ one has $c_1 = \cos(\varphi/2) \geq 0$ but c_2 may be negative): $w(x, -y, \alpha) = w(x, y, \pi - \alpha)$, and the substitution $\alpha \mapsto \pi - \alpha$ over a full period maps the first identity to itself (both sides even in y) and the second to its negative on both sides simultaneously (I_1 odd; $(-y + x \cos(\pi - \alpha)) = -(y + x \cos \alpha)$).

With $K_2(\varphi) = I_0(2\beta \cos(\varphi/2)) = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} I_m^2 e^{im\varphi}$ and $P_4 = K_2 * K_2$ (circle convolution), $P_4 = \sum_m I_m^4 e^{imt}$ and $F_B = -\frac{1}{2}P_4'$. Applying Lemma 44 to both convolution factors:

Lemma 46 (exact; master representation). *Let $s = \varphi - t/2$, $c_1 = \cos(\varphi/2)$, $c_2 = \cos((t - \varphi)/2)$, $P = \sin^2(s/2)$, $Q = \sin^2(\alpha/2)$, and*

$$R^2 = c_1^2 + c_2^2 + 2c_1c_2 \cos \alpha = 4[\cos^2(t/4)(1 - P - Q) + PQ]. \quad (8)$$

Then

$$F_B(t) = \frac{\beta \sin(t/2)}{8\pi^2} \iint_{[-\pi, \pi]^2} \frac{I_1(2\beta R)}{R} [\cos^2(s/2) - \sin^2(\alpha/2)] ds d\alpha, \quad (9)$$

and, under the common positive kernel $K = I_1(2\beta R)/R$,

$$E(t) = \frac{\langle \cos(t/2) \cos 2s + \cos \alpha [\cos(t/2) \cos s - \sin^2 s] \rangle}{\langle \cos s + \cos \alpha \rangle}, \quad (10)$$

where $\langle \cdot \rangle$ denotes the $K ds d\alpha$ -integral over $[-\pi, \pi]^2$. The prefactor collapse behind (9) is the sum-to-product symmetrization $\frac{1}{2}[\sin(\frac{t-\varphi}{2})(c_2 + c_1 \cos \alpha) + (\varphi \leftrightarrow t - \varphi)] = \frac{1}{2} \sin(t/2)(\cos s + \cos \alpha)$, and $\cos s + \cos \alpha = 2[\cos^2(s/2) - \sin^2(\alpha/2)]$.

Proof. (i) The squared Graf identity gives $K_2(\varphi) = \sum_m I_m^2 e^{im\varphi}$; convolution multiplies Fourier coefficients, so $P_4 = \sum_m I_m^4 e^{imt}$ and, termwise (super-exponential decay), $F_B = -\frac{1}{2}P_4'$. (ii) Insert Lemma 44 (first formula) with $x = 2\beta c_1$, $y = 2\beta c_2$ into $P_4(t) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int K_2(\varphi) K_2(t - \varphi) d\varphi$: a two-dimensional integral of $I_0(2\beta R)$ with R as in (8); the (P, Q) form of R^2 is product-to-sum. (iii) Differentiate under the integral (smooth integrand, compact domain): $\partial_t I_0(2\beta R) = I_1(2\beta R) \cdot 2\beta \partial_t R$ and $2R \partial_t R = 2(c_2 + c_1 \cos \alpha) \partial_t c_2$ with $\partial_t c_2 = -\frac{1}{2} \sin((t - \varphi)/2)$. (iv) Symmetrize over $\varphi \leftrightarrow t - \varphi$ (R invariant): with $\sin(x/2) \cos(x/2) = \frac{1}{2} \sin x$ and the angle-addition formula,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2} [\sin(\frac{t-\varphi}{2})(c_2 + c_1 \cos \alpha) + \sin(\frac{\varphi}{2})(c_1 + c_2 \cos \alpha)] &= \frac{1}{4} [\sin(t - \varphi) + \sin \varphi] + \frac{1}{2} \sin(\frac{t}{2}) \cos \alpha \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sin(\frac{t}{2})(\cos s + \cos \alpha), \end{aligned}$$

using $\sin(t - \varphi) + \sin \varphi = 2 \sin(t/2) \cos s$ and $\sin(\frac{t-\varphi}{2})c_1 + \sin(\frac{\varphi}{2})c_2 = \sin(t/2)$. Collecting constants yields (9). The same substitution in the companion representation of F_A (Lemma 37 with Lemma 44, second formula) and cancellation of the common factor $\beta \sin(t/2)$ yields (10). As an end-to-end check, (9) and (10) match the quartic series with ratio 1.000000000000 at $t \in \{0.4, 1.1, 2.3, 2.9\}$, $\beta = 4$. $\square$

Lemma 47 (exact; geometry of the (P, Q) square, $0 < t < \pi$). On $[0, 1]^2$: the main saddle is $(0, 0)$ with $R = 2 \cos(t/4)$; the secondary saddle is $(1, 1)$ with $R = 2 \sin(t/4)$ and gap $2(\cos(t/4) - \sin(t/4)) > 0$ degenerating only at $t = \pi$; the zero set $\{R = 0\}$ consists of exactly the two corners $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$, and at both of them both brackets of (9) and (10) vanish, so the singular points of K are switched off (the extension $I_1(z)/z \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}$ makes K continuous with value β). At $t = 0$ the zero set degenerates to the edges $P = 1, Q = 1$. The saddle deficit is the exact sum of two squares

$$4 \cos^2(t/4) - R^2 = 4 \cos^2(t/4) \sin^2(s/2) + 4c_1c_2 \sin^2(\alpha/2), \quad c_1c_2 = \cos^2(t/4) - \sin^2(s/2), \quad (11)$$

with sign region $c_1c_2 \geq 0 \iff |s| \leq \pi - t/2$.

Proof. (8) and (11) are product-to-sum computations (symbolic zeros). $R^2 \geq (|c_1| - |c_2|)^2$ with equality forcing $|c_1| = |c_2|$ (i.e. $s = 0$ or $s = \pm\pi$) and $\cos \alpha = \mp \text{sign}(c_1c_2)$, which lands exactly on $(P, Q) \in \{(0, 1), (1, 0)\}$. Bracket vanishing at both points is direct substitution. The Jacobian of $(s, \alpha) \mapsto (P, Q)$ carries the arcsine weight $ds d\alpha = dP dQ / \sqrt{P(1-P)Q(1-Q)}$ (per quadrant), singular at all four corners; near the main saddle one therefore works in (s, α) , and in (P, Q) only for the global geometry. $\square$

Lemma 48 (exact; saddle cancellations). Write N, D for numerator and denominator brackets of (10), $C = \cos(t/2)$, $c_0 = \cos(t/4)$. At the saddle $(s, \alpha) = (0, 0)$:

$$\frac{N}{D} \Big|_{(0,0)} = C, \quad N_{\alpha\alpha} - C D_{\alpha\alpha} = 0, \quad N_{ss} - C D_{ss} = -4C - 2,$$

and for $N_t = -\frac{1}{2} \sin(t/2) [\cos 2s + \cos \alpha \cos s]$:

$$N_{t,\alpha\alpha} - m D_{\alpha\alpha} = 0 \quad (m = -\frac{1}{2} \sin(t/2)), \quad N_{t,ss} - m D_{ss} = 2 \sin(t/2).$$

Also exact: $2C + 1 = 4c_0^2 - 1$ and $C c(t) = 2c_0 - 1/(2c_0)$ for $c(t) = (4c_0^2 - 1)/(2c_0C)$.

Proposition 49 (verified; the second-order laws). The frozen-kernel expansion built on Lemma 48 (with $\langle s^2 \rangle = 1/(\beta c_0) + O(\beta^{-2})$ from (11)) predicts

$$E = C \left(1 - \frac{c(t)}{\beta}\right) + O(\beta^{-2}), \quad E' = -\frac{1}{2} \sin(t/2) + \frac{\sin(t/4)(4c_0^2 + 1)}{8\beta c_0^2} + O(\beta^{-2}). \quad (12)$$

The coefficient identities are exact (Lemma 48); the laws with remainder are verified, not yet certified: measured remainders are $\approx 0.15/\beta^2$ with true convergence at fixed t (e.g. β^2 -scaled residues $0.1776/0.1767/0.1762$ at $t = 1, \beta = 30/60/120$), and $\beta(E' + \frac{1}{2} \sin(t/2)) \rightarrow \sin(t/4)(4c_0^2 + 1)/(8c_0^2)$ at $t = 1, 2$. The remainder control is exactly what the closure map owes. Note the $1/\beta$ correction to E' is positive: it opposes the target inequality and must be beaten, not used. The α -cancellations imply every kernel correction multiplies a vanishing fluctuation and enters at $O(\beta^{-2})$ only.

Remark 50 (exact decomposition of E'). With the normalized positive measure $d\mu \propto K ds d\alpha$, $E' = \langle N_t \rangle / \langle D \rangle + \langle (N - ED) \partial_t \log K \rangle / \langle D \rangle$, $D_t = 0$, and the regular form $\partial_t \log K = 4cc'(1 - P - Q) [zI_0(z)/I_1(z) - 2]/R^2$, $z = 2\beta R$, extends continuously by $4\beta^2 cc'(1 - P - Q)$ at $R = 0$. Verified split at $(\beta, t) = (5, 1.3)$: $-0.238212 - 0.024552 = -0.262764 =$ the finite difference exactly. Bounds for E' are taken from this exact quotient — never by differentiating an estimate of E .

8 The π -endpoint package

Lemma 51 (exact; telescoping). *With a_m as in (1):*

$$A_\infty := \sum_{m \geq 1} (-1)^{m+1} m a_m = 0, \quad \sum_{m \geq 1} (-1)^{m+1} m^3 a_m = - \sum_{m \geq 1} (-1)^{m+1} m(m+1)(2m+1) I_m^2 I_{m+1}^2.$$

Hence $F_A(\pi - \varepsilon) = c_3 \varepsilon^3 + O(\varepsilon^5)$ with

$$c_3 = \frac{1}{6} \sum_{m \geq 1} (-1)^{m+1} m(m+1)(2m+1) I_m^2 I_{m+1}^2. \quad (13)$$

Proof. Split $m^r a_m = m^r(m-1)I_{m-1}^2 I_m^2 + m^r(m+1)I_m^2 I_{m+1}^2$ and shift $m \rightarrow m+1$ in the first sum: for $r = 1$ the two weights cancel ($m(m+1) - m(m+1) = 0$); for $r = 3$ they combine to $m(m+1)[m^2 - (m+1)^2] = -m(m+1)(2m+1)$. Absolute convergence justifies the reindexing; $\sin(m(\pi - \varepsilon)) = (-1)^{m+1} \sin(m\varepsilon)$ expands the sine. $\square$

Lemma 52 (exact; integral form and parity). *Let $g(u) = \frac{1}{2} I_1(2\beta \cos u) = \sum_{m \geq 0} I_m I_{m+1} \cos((2m+1)u)$ (addition theorem). Then*

$$c_3 = \frac{S_3 - S_1}{24}, \quad S_1 = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^\pi g\left(\frac{\pi}{2} - u\right) g'(u) du, \quad S_3 = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^\pi g'\left(\frac{\pi}{2} - u\right) (-g''(u)) du.$$

Moreover $g(-u) = g(u)$ and $g(\pi - u) = -g(u)$ (parity of I_1), hence $g'(\pi - u) = g'(u)$, $g''(\pi - u) = -g''(u)$, and both integrands are invariant under $u \mapsto \pi - u$: the two halves $[0, \pi/2]$ and $[\pi/2, \pi]$ contribute exactly equally, and one may integrate a half range and double. In particular no cancellation between the two phase maxima $u = \pi/4$ and $u = 3\pi/4$ is possible — exactly, not asymptotically.

Proof. The expansion of g is the Graf addition theorem with unit shift. Quarter turn: $\cos((2m+1)(\frac{\pi}{2} - u)) = (-1)^m \sin((2m+1)u)$, so $g(\frac{\pi}{2} - u) = \sum_m (-1)^m I_m I_{m+1} \sin((2m+1)u)$ while $g'(u) = -\sum_k (2k+1) I_k I_{k+1} \sin((2k+1)u)$ and $g''(u) = -\sum_k (2k+1)^2 I_k I_{k+1} \cos((2k+1)u)$, whence $g'(\frac{\pi}{2} - u) = -\sum_k (-1)^k (2k+1) I_k I_{k+1} \cos((2k+1)u)$. Orthogonality of $\{\sin((2m+1)u)\}$ and $\{\cos((2m+1)u)\}$ on $[0, \pi]$ (norm $\pi/2$) gives $S_1 = -\sum_m (-1)^m (2m+1) (I_m I_{m+1})^2$ and $S_3 = -\sum_m (-1)^m (2m+1)^3 (I_m I_{m+1})^2$, so

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{S_3 - S_1}{24} &= \sum_{m \geq 0} (-1)^{m+1} \frac{(2m+1)^3 - (2m+1)}{24} (I_m I_{m+1})^2 \\ &= \frac{1}{6} \sum_{m \geq 1} (-1)^{m+1} m(m+1)(2m+1) I_m^2 I_{m+1}^2 = c_3, \end{aligned}$$

using $(2m+1)^3 - (2m+1) = 4m(m+1)(2m+1)$ and the vanishing of the $m = 0$ term. The parity claims follow from $I_1(-z) = -I_1(z)$ applied to $g(\pi - u) = \frac{1}{2} I_1(-2\beta \cos u)$, and by differentiating the two symmetry relations. $\square$

Proposition 53 (verified; prefactor law). $c_3 > 0$ for $\beta \in \{1, 5, 20, 40, 80, 120\}$ at cancellation-adjusted precision (the alternating sum cancels at scale $e^{-(4-2\sqrt{2})\beta}$; evaluations use $\text{dps} \geq 0.6\beta + 50$), and

$$c_3 \sim A \beta^{3/2} e^{2\sqrt{2}\beta}, \quad A = \frac{1}{24 \cdot 2^{1/4} \pi^{3/2}} = 0.0062922 \dots,$$

with measured ratios 0.0058646, 0.0060049, 0.0060996, 0.0061475 at $\beta = 40, 60, 90, 120$ and $O(1/\beta)$ gaps. The certified large- β branch (pending) must produce the signed prefactor with an explicit B : $I_{\text{half}} \geq \frac{A}{2}\beta^{3/2}e^{2\sqrt{2}\beta}(1 - B/\beta) - T(\beta)$, $c_3 = 2I_{\text{half}}$, read β^* , and close $[15, B_{\text{fin}}]$, $B_{\text{fin}} = \max\{\beta^*, 10C\}$, by intervals.

9 The closure map and the candidate threshold

Proposition 54 (verified truth map; all statements on the stated finite grids). *Let $g(t, \beta) = E' + \frac{1}{4}\sin(t/2)$. At $\beta = 15$, $g < 0$ at every point of a 13-point grid spanning $[0.05, \pi - 0.09]$ (independently reproduced on a much finer mesh at 110 digits), with thinnest margin -0.00573 at $t = 0.05$ (on the seal window $[0.05, \pi - 0.10]$) and -0.00216 at $\pi - 0.09$; the crossing sits at $\pi - t^* = 0.0890502225$. At $\beta = 12$ the truth itself fails at $\pi - 0.10$ ($g = +0.025$); crossings scale as the mirror window: $\pi - t^* = 0.1155, 0.0891, 0.0644$ at $\beta = 12, 15, 20$, matching $\sqrt{2}/\beta$. A sweep $\beta = 15 \dots 60$ keeps the maximum at $t = 0.05$, drifting to -0.0061 : strong uniformity evidence, not proof.*

Conjecture 55 (the pending rows of the relay, quantified). *Part (ii) of Conjecture 1 holds with the two-scale decomposition: (a) $0 < \beta \leq 3$ by Theorem 34; (b) $\beta \in [3, 15]$ by certified evaluation (the holonomic structure of Section 10 makes the compact cheap); (c) $\beta \geq 15$ by three uniform blocks (windows per the LIVE map of Section 2, superseding earlier drafts): left edge $(0, 0.6]$ (by the ratified sinc route of Remark 4: the exact sinc positivity of Lemma 5, the certified minor criterion with control of the high-frequency tail $m+n > \pi/t$, and the uniform splice overlap with the integrator strip extended down to $t_*(\beta) \approx 0.45$); bulk $[0.6, \pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta]$ (enclosure of $\langle s^2 \rangle$ and of the covariance of Remark 50, with the five prototype-to-certificate conversions); right edge with moving boundary: assembly to $\pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta$, then the quadratic regime of c_3 on $[\pi - C_{\text{win}}/\beta, \pi]$ with $C_{\text{mirror}} \leq C_{\text{win}} \leq C_{\text{quad}}$ (a fixed quadratic window is provably impossible: $\kappa \approx 0.11\beta$ grows while $E(\pi - 0.10)$ stays bounded; retention $E/\kappa d^2$ at $d = 2/\beta$ is 0.896, 0.892, 0.890 at $\beta = 20, 40, 80$ — the validity radius scales as $1/\beta$). The named constants still owed: B , β^* , C_{quad} , C_{mirror} , and the remainder function $T(\beta)$.*

The first-order competition is not the obstacle: the two-term law (12) requires only $\beta > (1 + 1/(4c_0^2))/c_0 \leq 3\sqrt{2}/2 \approx 2.121$; everything above that is rigor slack. The candidate $\beta_0 = 15$ is near truth-optimal for its edge window (Proposition 54), not padded.

10 Verification, certificates, and reproducibility

All numerical artifacts live in the repository

<https://github.com/lluiseiriksson/THE-ERIKSSON-PROGRAMME>

(directories `scripts/`, `docs/`); the immutable commit hash for the version audited with this manuscript is recorded in the repository's hash registry (`docs/SURFACE-CLOSURE-NOTES.md`) and in the arXiv comment field on submission. Each certificate embeds its pinned statement and self-verifies on every execution.

Certificates (interval arithmetic, outward rounding, nested or stability passes). `certify_time3_negative.py` and its Arb twin (Proposition 40); `certify_bridge_matrix.py` and twin (Proposition 41); `certify_thmB.py` (Theorem 34: adaptive β -boxes covering $[1/20, 3]$;

tails computed in intervals and closed at the level of *complete shells*: each pair maps into the next shell with term ratio r derived from the termwise-exact $I_{n+1}(x) \leq xI_n(x)/(2(n+1))$, and the one new pair per shell is bounded by a double index shift, giving shell ratio $2r$, asserted $< \frac{1}{2}$ per box before the geometric closure; a built-in full stability pass at precision $+70$; the Arb twin `certify_thmB_arb.py` independently certifies the full coverage — 86 boxes, both passes, transcript archived; the `mpmath.iv` canonical transcript is committed on completion of its run, as recorded in the repository hash registry). Bessel enclosures use the positive series with an exact-integer stopping rule and geometric tails; floats appear only in loop-termination heuristics. Nested enclosures prevent silent numerical or truncation degradation; statement auditing and the independent Arb implementation guard against common-mode errors.

Verified computations. The master-formula and reduction identities (ratios 1.0 to 12 digits); the truth map of Proposition 54 (dps 80, confirmed independently at 110 digits); the c_3 ladder (Proposition 53); the term-split coefficients of (12) at $\beta = 60, 120, 240$.

Precision policies (each traceable to a caught artifact): $\text{dps} \geq 2.2\beta + 40$ for any evaluation with $t \geq 2$, $\beta > 30$ (mirror cancellation); $\text{dps} \geq 0.6\beta + 50$ for c_3 -type alternating sums; series cutoffs scale with the maximal argument, and scaled-asymptotic evaluation of $e^{-z}I_n(z)$ is the default for $z > 35$; every measured coefficient carries a β -scaling sanity check; whatever can be computed from a positive integral representation is.

Audit trail. Fifteen numerical or formulation artifacts (“ghosts”) were caught during fabrication and writing by the three-way review protocol; Appendix B tabulates them. We consider the table part of the result: it is the reproducibility record that makes the certificates credible.

Machine-checked lemmas. The unit-step and Turán-type coefficient inequalities behind Theorem 34 are formalized in Lean 4/Mathlib (`PhiMonotone.lean`, `FHBesselAmos.lean`, `WronskianIdentity.lean`; axiom oracle `[propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]`, no sorry). Mathlib has no Bessel functions: what is machine-checked is the ordered-field implication, with the analytic inputs (three-term recurrence [4, 10.29.1]; the Amos-type bound of [1, 2, 3], cited verbatim, shift $\nu \rightarrow \nu + 1$ as in Appendix A) carried as named hypotheses. Correct claim everywhere: *machine-checked modulo classical Bessel inputs carried as named hypotheses*.

Acknowledgements and provenance

The conjecture, the bridge reading, the reduction, and all certificates were produced inside an audit-first programme in which three independent reviewing voices verify every claim before acceptance; scores, objections, and the complete ghost ledger are archived with the repository history. Nothing in this paper rests on trust in any single computation: every load-bearing negative has two witnesses, and every identity marked exact has a symbolic-zero transcript.

A The weighted Turán-type lemma, self-contained

Theorem 56 (exact). *For every $x > 0$ and every real $m \geq 1$, with $\varphi_m = a_m/b_m$ built from (1) at argument x : $\varphi_m < \varphi_{m+1}$. Equivalently, with $\rho_\mu = I_{\mu+1}/I_\mu$,*

$$\frac{1}{m} \left(\frac{m-1}{\rho_{m-1}^2} + (m+1)\rho_m^2 \right) < \frac{1}{m+1} \left(\frac{m}{\rho_m^2} + (m+2)\rho_{m+1}^2 \right).$$

Proof. Two classical inputs, valid for all real orders: the three-term recurrence $\rho_{m-1}^{-1} = \rho_m +$

$2m/x$, $\rho_{m+1} = \rho_m^{-1} - 2(m+1)/x$ [4, 10.29.1], and the Amos-type bound

$$\rho_m(x) < U_m(x) := \frac{x}{a + \sqrt{a^2 + x^2}}, \quad a = m + \frac{1}{2},$$

proved best of its form for all real orders ≥ 0 by Segura [2]; we use [3, Thm. 2], which bounds $I_\nu(x)/I_{\nu-1}(x)$ for $\nu \geq \frac{1}{2}$ by $x/(\nu - \frac{1}{2} + \sqrt{(\nu - \frac{1}{2})^2 + x^2})$; setting $\nu = m+1$ bounds $\rho_m = I_{m+1}/I_m$ by $x/(m + \frac{1}{2} + \sqrt{(m + \frac{3}{2})^2 + x^2}) \leq x/(a + \sqrt{a^2 + x^2})$ with $a = m + \frac{1}{2}$, which is the displayed bound (the last step uses $\sqrt{(m + \frac{3}{2})^2 + x^2} \geq \sqrt{a^2 + x^2}$). Substitute the recurrences, write $u = \rho_m \in (0, 1)$, $c = 1/x$, $S = u + 1/u$, $P = 1/u - u$; clearing the positive denominators, the claim becomes $\Delta_m > 0$ where the *exact factorization*

$$\frac{\Delta_m}{2m(m+1)} = (S - 3c)(P - (2m+1)c) + (2m+1)c^2$$

holds as an algebraic identity (expand and collect; the coefficients of $u^{\pm 2}$ are $\pm 2m(m+1)$, the linear-in- c terms are $-4m(m+1)c[(m-1)u + (m+2)/u]$, and $(m-1)u + (m+2)/u = \frac{1}{2}[(2m+1)S + 3P]$, $1/u^2 - u^2 = PS$). The second factor is positive because U_m is the positive root of $1/w - w = (2m+1)/x$ (the calibration $1/U_m - U_m = 2a/x$) and $w \mapsto 1/w - w$ is strictly decreasing, so $\rho_m < U_m$ gives $P > (2m+1)c$. The first factor is positive because $\sqrt{a^2 + x^2} > a$ gives $U_m < x/(2a)$, so $u < x/(2m+1) \leq x/3$ and $S > 1/u > (2m+1)/x \geq 3c$. The third term is positive. Strictness is strict throughout. (This is the proof of [6], reproduced so that Theorem 34 is self-contained; the ordered-field implication is machine-checked in `PhiMonotone.lean`, modulo the two classical inputs carried as named hypotheses.) $\square$

B Audit table (the ghost ledger)

Each row: what was wrong, how it was caught, and the rule it produced. All entries are documented with transcripts in `docs/SURFACE-CLOSURE-NOTES.md`.

#	artifact	catch / rule produced
1	random TP_2 scan missed adversarial corners	targeted corner search; adversarial grids mandatory
2	verification cell with unbound parameter	explicit binding rule for inline prints
3	near- π scan at low precision, false violation	precision rule $\text{dps} \geq 2.2\beta + 40$ for $t \geq 2$, $\beta > 30$
4	stale-PDF claim misattributed between voices	provenance ledger: attribute to exact source
5	float64 CDF increments ± 11 (impossible)	positive-representation preference
6	$t=2$, $\beta=240$ residue 0.363 vs 0.317	boundary $t \geq 2$ included in the dps rule
7	I_1 series truncated at 60 terms, $z \leq 480$	cutoffs scale with argument; scaled asymptotics for $z > 35$; β -scaling checks
8	c_3 sign flip at $\beta = 120$ (cancellation)	alternating-sum rule $\text{dps} \geq 0.6\beta + 50$
9	$R = 0$ corner misplaced at $(1, 1)$	complete critical-point census required in prose too
10	one-saddle prefactor off by exactly 2	census rule; the factor 2 later proved an exact parity
11	I_1 lower bound dropped the negative tail	sign audits are a separate mandatory pass
12	fixed quadratic window at π was provably false	interrogate obligations before attempting them
13	Thm. A second proof: rearrangement misquoted	layer-cake arc proof substituted (this revision)
14	Lemma sign error: floor stated as upper bound	corrected; per-pair statements now carry signs explicitly
15	“exact” labels on verified inequalities	tricotomy re-audit of every label (this revision)

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